BONUS 01

20 READY-TO-USE VOCAL ROUTINES

Progressive twelve-minute sequences, from easy readiness to repertoire integration.



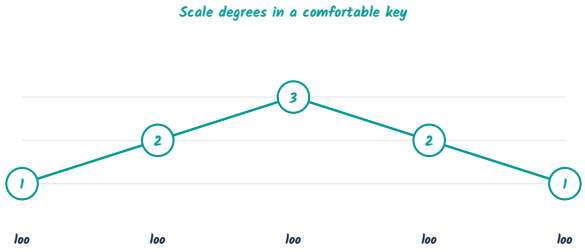
Feet supported | Use a stable chair | See the director without craning

FIND SUPPORT



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

COORDINATE



KEEP IT EASY



Watch the preparation | Breathe without holding | "loo" on the downbeat

TRANSFER

Illustrated methods you can understand, try, and use in real music.

Use a routine with purpose

How the progression works

Routines 01-05 establish comfortable readiness, 06-10 coordinate basic skills, 11-15 combine them, and 16-20 transfer them to practical rehearsal situations. Progression means more coordination, not louder or higher singing.

Twelve minutes, with recovery

Each routine has five blocks: one minute for arrival, two for breathing and speech, three for gentle sound, three for coordination, and three for repertoire transfer. These times include modelling, listening, rest, and feedback. Do not vocalize continuously.

Before starting

Choose a comfortable starting pitch; numbered patterns are major scale degrees, not fixed notes. Allow seated participation, appropriate octave choices, a shorter pattern, speech, or listening. Stop tasks that cause pain, dizziness, or strain. Rest a hoarse or tired voice.

Check the transfer

The final block is the test: did the selected skill help the actual phrase? Keep one clear observation and choose the next routine based on the group's needs rather than completing every routine in order.



Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

ROUTINE 01

Easy First Rehearsal

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

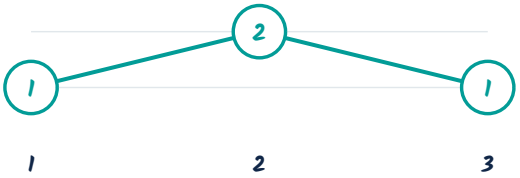
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Build a comfortable first shared sound.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Find a supported stance and release clenched hands.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Use an ordinary breath before a quiet four-beat 'sss'; rest between turns.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hum one note for two beats, then open to 'oo' without increasing volume.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-2-1 on 'loo'; keep the same key until it feels easy.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the first two words of today's song, then the opening phrase with the same ease.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 02

Seated Readiness

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a group that rehearses mainly seated.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Set chairs and scores so feet are supported and the director is visible.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Breathe normally, speak 'We are ready', and notice any shoulder shrug.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing two gentle 'mm-oo' sounds with a normal breathing break.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Use 3-2-1 on 'oh', pausing after every pattern.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing a short line from the score while looking up before its entrance.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

ROUTINE 03

Quiet Morning Start

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

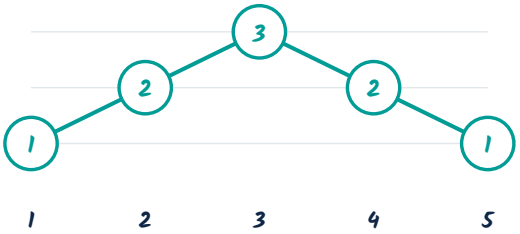
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Begin without demanding immediate volume or range.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Check comfort and invite singers to listen if their voices feel tired.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak a short greeting with an easy preparatory breath.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hum briefly on a comfortable note, rest, then repeat once on 'oo'.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing 1-2-3-2-1 gently, staying within a modest middle range.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing one phrase at a comfortable medium level; postpone high or demanding passages.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 04

Clear Words Foundation

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Connect easy sound to understandable text.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Unclench the jaw and speak a short lyric conversationally.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak the lyric after an ordinary breath, placing a pause where its meaning allows.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one comfortable note with a rest after each cycle.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Speak 'Bright morning, clear sky' on four beats, putting vowels on the beat.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the lyric first on its vowels, then restore concise consonants.

WATCH FOR THIS

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

ROUTINE 05

Shared Pulse Starter

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

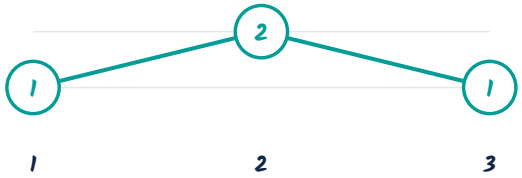
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare coordination before adding difficult notes.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Settle the feet and establish a gentle tapping pulse.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak one line over four beats after a quiet preparation.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Echo 1-2-1 on 'noo', allowing four silent beats to recover.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Alternate 'ta ta ti-ti ta' and 'ta rest ta ta' without speeding up.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Speak, then sing a rhythmically simple phrase from the repertoire.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 06

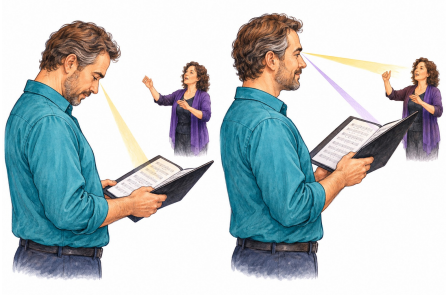
Connected Vowel Line

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

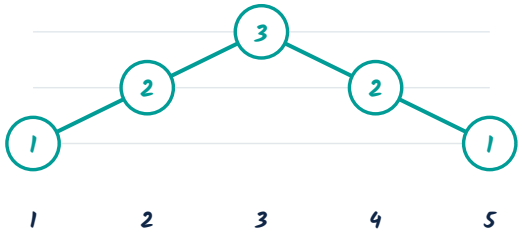
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep a continuous sound through small pitch changes.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Release shoulder effort and hold the score lightly.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak a four-word phrase, choosing one shared breath point.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Move gently from 'mm' to 'oo' on one note.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing 1-2-3-2-1 on one continuous vowel, resting between repetitions.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Replace the vowel with the song's actual vowels before adding consonants.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 07

Listen Then Enter

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

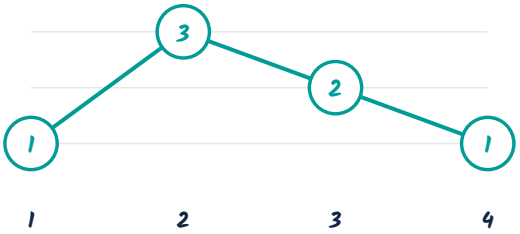
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Improve entrances by preparing with eyes and ears.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Arrange singers so everyone has a clear view of the director.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Follow three silent preparation gestures with ordinary breaths and immediate release.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Listen to one note, hum it briefly, then hear the reference again.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-3-2-1 only after the complete model and its response cue.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Rehearse the first entrance after a rest in today's piece.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

ROUTINE 08

Descending Ease

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep the end of a descending line clear.



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Find a supported standing or seated position without lifting the chin.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Release an easy four-beat 'sss', followed by normal breathing.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 3-2-1 on 'oo' with an easy ending.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

If comfortable, use 5-4-3-2-1 without pushing low notes; otherwise keep three notes.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the same descending shape to one ending in the repertoire.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

ROUTINE 09

Vowel Agreement

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Establish a repeatable shared vowel for one phrase.



oo — oh — ah

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Speak a problematic word naturally with an easy jaw.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Read the phrase and mark an unhurried breath before it.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 'oo-oh' on one note while keeping the pitch steady.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Compare three spoken versions of the target word and choose one appropriate to the language.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the word on its melody, then place it back inside the phrase.

WATCH FOR THIS

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

ROUTINE 10

Steady Short Phrases

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep the second phrase as ready as the first.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Release finger grip and check that the score does not hide the cue.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak two short lines with a clear recovery breath between them.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hum for two beats, rest for two, then open a second hum to 'oo'.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing two four-beat 'loo' patterns with a two-beat recovery gap.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing two adjacent song phrases with the planned recovery time.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

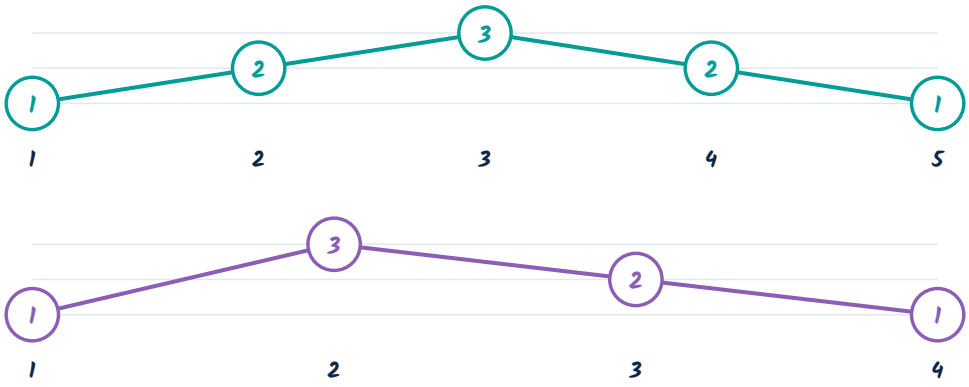
ROUTINE II

Pitch and Pulse Together

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Combine accurate note direction with a stable beat.



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Settle the group and tap a slow common pulse.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak four words on the pulse after a natural preparation.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Echo 1-2-3-2-1, one note per beat.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Alternate that pattern with 1-3-2-1; listen fully before responding.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Find the matching pattern in the score and sing it without losing the beat.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

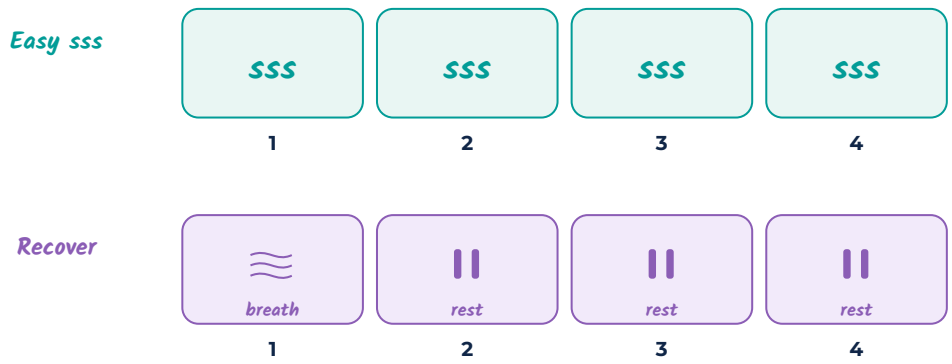
ROUTINE 12

Gentle Dynamic Control

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare two useful volume levels without forcing.



One even four-beat release, then normal breathing before another attempt.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Release a rigid posture and choose a comfortable upper volume.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Take an ordinary breath and speak a short line gently, then at normal conversational level.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing a comfortable note first gently and then at medium level, resting between turns.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Use a short three-note phrase with a small growth that stops at the agreed ceiling.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the two levels to contrasting lines in the music without changing tempo.

WATCH FOR THIS

The air stream stays even and the ending does not collapse or squeeze.

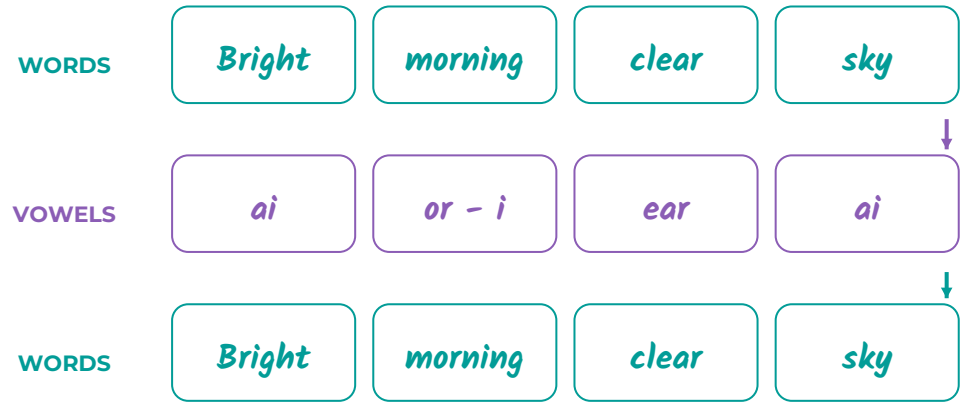
ROUTINE 13

Clean Group Endings

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Coordinate the final vowel, consonant, and release.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Check sightlines and rehearse the release gesture silently.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Sing a three-beat note after an easy breath and release on beat four.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Use 'oo' for the same task, maintaining the vowel until the cue.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing 'light', placing its final 't' at the release rather than early.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Practise the final two words of the repertoire and reconnect the full ending.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

ROUTINE 14

Two-Part Listening

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

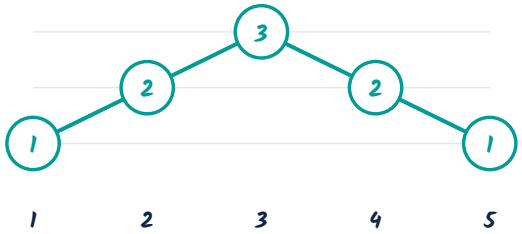
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Introduce a second sound without overpowering it.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Place two groups where each can hear the other clearly.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Use brief phrases with ample recovery time; nobody sustains beyond comfort.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Establish a gentle home note on 'oo', then rest.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

One group sings home while the other sings 1-2-3-2-1; exchange after a rest.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the listening balance to two overlapping lines in current music.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

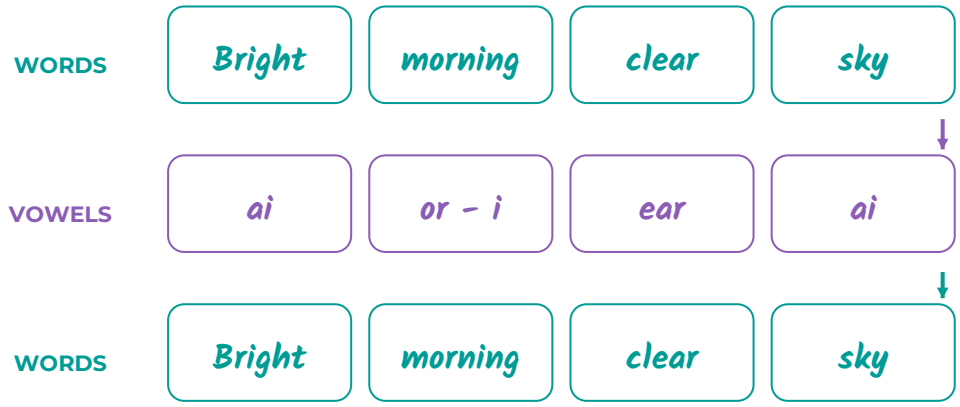
ROUTINE 15

Text With Direction

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Carry meaning through a connected phrase.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Speak the lyric and choose one word as its destination.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Mark a breath that supports that meaning without splitting a word.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing a three-note 'loo' line with a gentle forward sense.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing the actual vowels toward the selected word, keeping surrounding syllables clear.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Restore the words and ask listeners which word carried the message.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

ROUTINE 16

Prepared Page Turn

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep the first note secure after handling the score.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Arrange folders and identify a safe page-turn location.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Practise the turn silently while breathing normally and watching for the next cue.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing one brief 'mm-oo' after a preparation gesture.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing a short phrase, turn the page, and listen to a fresh starting note before continuing.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Practise the real page turn between two song fragments without rushing.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

ROUTINE 17

Recovery After Silence

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Maintain readiness through an instrumental or spoken gap.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Choose a visible place to watch during the gap.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Take ordinary breaths through the silence rather than preparing too early and holding air.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Hear a comfortable reference, hum it, then rest.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing a short pattern, think it silently for two beats, and return on cue.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Rehearse the re-entry after the longest silence in today's music.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

ROUTINE 18

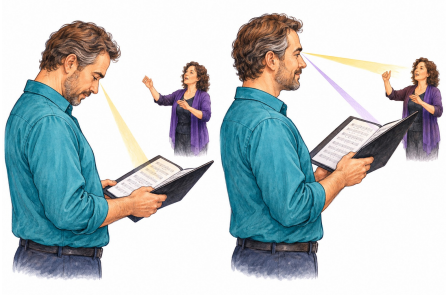
Performance Opening

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

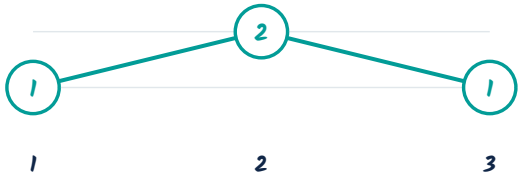
12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a reliable opening without over-rehearsing it.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Rehearse arrival, score position, and eye contact once.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Follow the director's silent preparation with an easy breath.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing 1-2-1 gently, then rest before any transposition.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Sing the opening words on one note, aligning initial consonants and vowels.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Perform only the first ten seconds twice, with a full reset and useful feedback between attempts.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

ROUTINE 19

Phrase-Level Integration

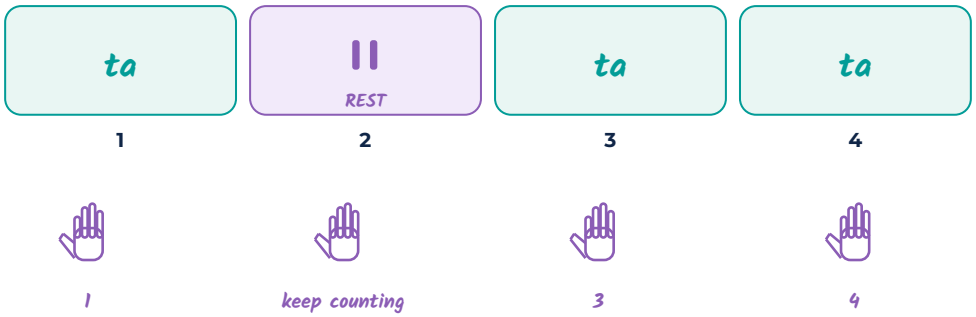
Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Transfer several established skills into one short passage.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS



Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Name one posture adjustment and one musical focus for today.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Speak the passage and agree the shared breath location.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Sing its smallest pitch pattern on 'oo', choosing a comfortable key.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Restore rhythm and vowels, then the complete text without adding extra effort.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Sing the whole passage and assess only the chosen focus, recording one next action.

WATCH FOR THIS

The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

ROUTINE 20

Independent Warm-Up Plan

Ready-to-Use Vocal Routines

12 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Help singers understand why a routine is chosen.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Arrive

Ask the choir to identify today's main need: readiness, clarity, timing, or expression.

01:00 to 03:00

Breathe & speak

Choose an easy breath-and-speech preparation that fits that need.

03:00 to 06:00

Easy sound

Select either gentle humming or a short three-note echo, with recovery breaks.

06:00 to 09:00

Coordinate

Choose one rhythm, vowel, or listening task that directly addresses the selected need.

09:00 to 12:00

Transfer

Apply the task to a real phrase and explain what improved and what still needs work.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

BONUS 02

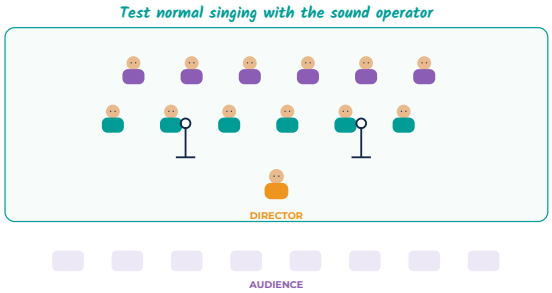
STAGE-READY CHOIR

A practical guide to programme planning, cues, scores, soundcheck, backstage preparation, and calm recovery.



WALK THE ROUTE → SETTLE + SEE THE CUE

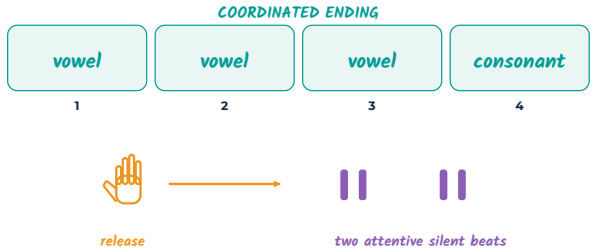
A USABLE ROUTE



SOUNDCHECK

FINAL RELEASE — Finish together
→ **QUIET PAGE CHANGE** — Find the next page
→ **STARTING NOTE** — Listen quietly
→ **NEW CUE** — Wait for preparation

TRANSITIONS



CLEAR ENDINGS

Illustrated methods you can understand, try, and use in real music.

STAGE GUIDE 01

Start with a workable performance brief

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

A useful performance plan begins with the actual event, not an ideal concert.

WHEN + WHERE

Arrival + soundcheck

WHO + ACCESS

People + practical needs

TWO PRIORITIES

Musical + practical

Before you begin

A useful performance plan begins with the actual event, not an ideal concert. Write down the decisions that affect repertoire, people, timing, and access before rehearsing the running order.

Confirm with the organizer

Record the date, arrival time, soundcheck window, performance length, venue contact, and who can approve changes. Ask whether the event includes spoken introductions, prayer, awards, or other items between songs.

Know the practical limits

Confirm the available standing or seated space, accessible route, audience position, microphones, accompaniment, lighting, and music stands. Check whether singers need permission to enter the venue early.

Decide what success means

Choose one musical aim and one practical aim. Example: clear text in the central song, and a calm transition into the final item. Use these aims to prioritize the next rehearsal.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- [ ] Event contact and arrival time confirmed
- [ ] Actual performance duration recorded
- [ ] Access and equipment needs discussed
- [ ] One musical and one practical priority written

STAGE GUIDE 02

Choose repertoire the choir can deliver

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

The strongest programme is one the group can perform comfortably, clearly, and reliably.

READY

REPAIR ONE THING

NOT FOR THIS EVENT

Before you begin

The strongest programme is one the group can perform comfortably, clearly, and reliably. Familiarity, text, range, stamina, and preparation time matter more than the number of difficult pieces.

Use a readiness check

For each candidate song, assess starting notes, rhythm, text clarity, range comfort, memory expectations, and accompaniment. Mark each as ready, needs a specific repair, or not ready for this event.

Build contrast with purpose

Vary pace, mood, and texture while preserving a sensible vocal workload. Avoid placing several demanding pieces consecutively. Choose an opening the choir can enter confidently and a final item with a dependable ending.

Respect the music's permissions

Check that scores, arrangements, projected lyrics, accompaniment tracks, and any recording or streaming are licensed or otherwise permitted for the intended use. Owning a copy does not automatically permit every use.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ *Each song has a clear readiness status*
- ☐ *Text and event context are suitable*
- ☐ *Demanding passages are not clustered unnecessarily*
- ☐ *Required permissions have been checked*

STAGE GUIDE 03

Create an honest running order

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Time the whole sequence, including movement, introductions, applause, page changes, and starting notes.

9:40 planned + 0:20 margin = 10:00



Transitions and applause count as real time.

Before you begin

Time the whole sequence, including movement, introductions, applause, page changes, and starting notes. A list of song lengths alone underestimates the event.

Write a usable cue sheet

Use columns for item, duration, leader, starting pitch or accompaniment cue, equipment, and transition. Give every spoken introduction a maximum length and an owner.

Worked ten-minute example

Arrival and settle: 0:30. Introduction: 0:20. Song A: 2:20. Applause and reset: 0:25. Song B: 2:40. Short introduction: 0:20. Song C: 2:35. Final acknowledgement: 0:30. Planned total: 9:40, leaving twenty seconds of margin.

Test the transitions

Practise the final phrase of one item directly into the preparation for the next. Decide whether the choir remains still, changes formation, turns pages, or sits. Give each change enough time.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ *All items have an owner*
- ☐ *Transitions are included in the timing*
- ☐ *The actual total fits the allotted slot*
- ☐ *There is a small practical timing margin*

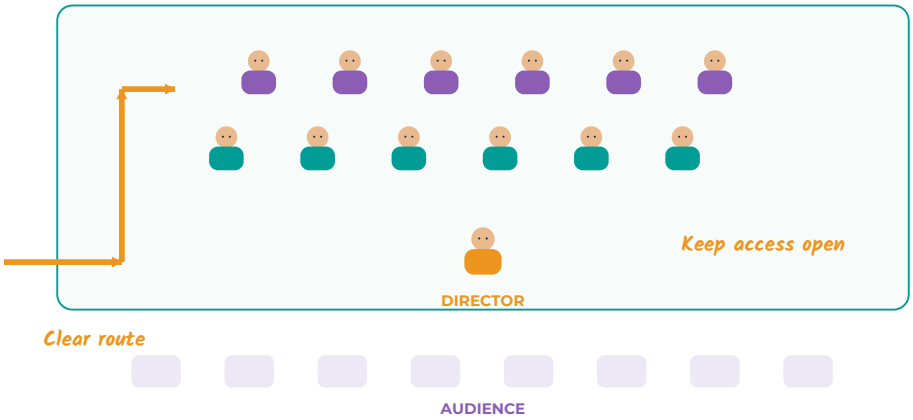
STAGE GUIDE 04

Plan a formation that people can use

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

A formation must support hearing, sightlines, access, and comfort.



Before you begin

A formation must support hearing, sightlines, access, and comfort. A visually neat arrangement is not useful if singers cannot see the director or safely reach their places.

Map the room

Sketch the audience, director, choir rows, accompaniment, microphone stands, doors, and cables. Mark accessible routes and any steps or risers that require special care.

Check from each position

Ask singers whether they can see the preparation and release gestures. Stagger rows where useful. Check seated singers and anyone using mobility aids before finalizing positions.

Test sound, then adjust

Sing one representative phrase at normal volume. Move positions only when there is a clear reason, such as blocked sightlines or an inaudible part. Keep changes simple enough to remember.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

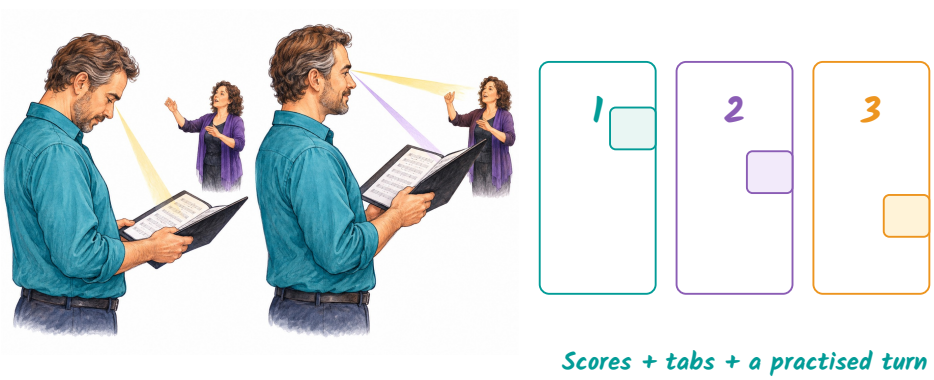
- [ ] Every singer has a clear sightline
- [ ] Entry and exit routes remain unobstructed
- [ ] Seats and mobility needs are included
- [ ] The formation has been tested with actual sound

Prepare scores and page turns

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Folders and scores are part of the performance setup.



Scores + tabs + a practised turn

Before you begin

Folders and scores are part of the performance setup. Rehearse using the materials the choir will actually hold, including any large-print or accessible versions.

Make the order unmistakable

Place scores in running order and label each clearly. Mark cuts, repeats, breath points, starting words, and page turns using the choir's agreed symbols. Remove obsolete annotations that create conflicting instructions.

Rehearse the difficult turn

Locate the last safe place to turn before an entrance. Practise the turn silently, then connect the words before and after it. Use a stand or a different copy arrangement if holding the folder causes discomfort.

Keep a backup

The leader should have the final running order, spare authorized copies where permitted, accompaniment details, and emergency contacts. Avoid making a phone battery the only way to access essential information.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ Scores match the final programme order
- ☐ Cuts and repeats agree across copies
- ☐ Difficult page turns have been practised
- ☐ Accessible materials and a practical backup exist

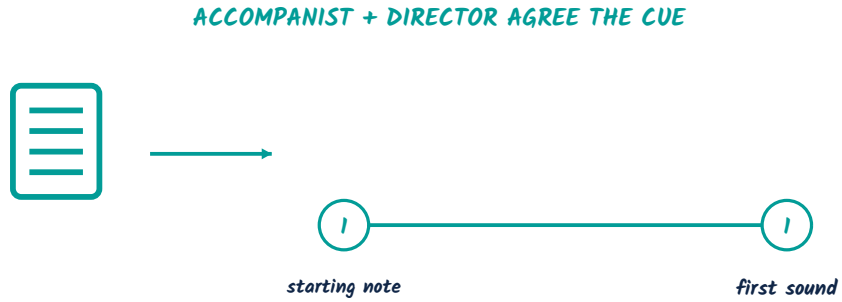
STAGE GUIDE 06

Coordinate accompaniment and starting pitches

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

The choir, director, and accompanist need the same version of every decision.



Before you begin

The choir, director, and accompanist need the same version of every decision. Agree the details early enough to rehearse them, especially introductions, repeats, tempo changes, and endings.

Confirm the version

Check key, arrangement, cuts, repeats, introductions, interludes, final chords, and any spoken lead-in. Mark who gives the first cue and who follows whom at each change.

Establish the first sound

Decide how each starting note will be given: instrument, pitch source, or confident model. Let the choir hear it before the preparation gesture. Do not ask singers to hold their breath during a long wait.

Practise a restart protocol

Choose a simple way to stop in rehearsal, identify a bar, hear the new starting notes, and begin again. During performance, use planned re-entry landmarks instead of restarting by habit.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- [ ] All performers use the same key and cuts
- [ ] Opening and final cues are agreed
- [ ] Starting pitches have a clear source
- [ ] At least two internal re-entry landmarks are known

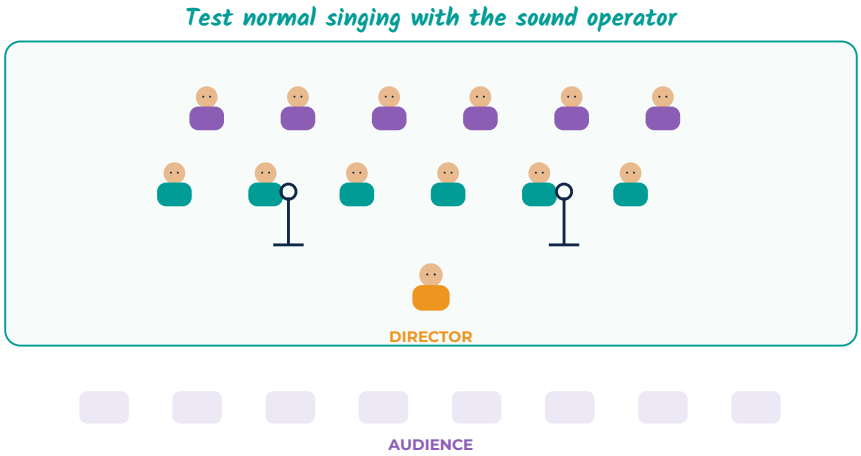
STAGE GUIDE 07

Use soundcheck for decisions, not a full rehearsal

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

A short, representative soundcheck is more useful than singing the whole programme repeatedly.



Before you begin

A short, representative soundcheck is more useful than singing the whole programme repeatedly. Work with the venue's sound operator and preserve a normal, comfortable singing level.

Choose a revealing excerpt

Include a clear text line, a fuller moment, and any exposed quiet passage. Tell the operator which parts need to remain audible. Use the actual choir formation and accompaniment.

Change the setup first

If clarity is poor, check microphone placement, monitor level, accompaniment balance, and sightlines with the operator. Avoid solving every sound problem by asking singers to sing louder.

Record the final arrangement

Note which stands, channels, positions, and cues are used. Keep cables out of walking routes. Do not move or adjust unfamiliar equipment without permission.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

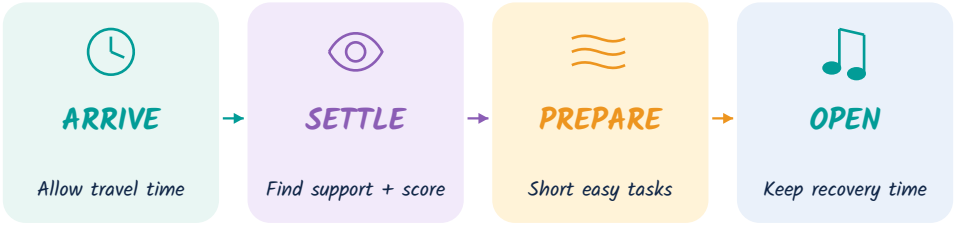
- ☐ *A representative excerpt is selected*
- ☐ *Normal vocal effort is maintained*
- ☐ *Operator and director agree the final setup*
- ☐ *Cables and microphone positions are safe*

Warm up for the task ahead

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Choose a familiar preparation that fits the event, the time available, and how the singers feel that day.



Before you begin

Choose a familiar preparation that fits the event, the time available, and how the singers feel that day. More warm-up is not automatically better, especially before a demanding programme.

Prepare in a sensible order

Settle body and attention, use an ordinary breath-and-speech task, introduce a gentle middle-range sound, then rehearse one feature that appears in the programme. Include recovery between repetitions.

Keep effort comfortable

Offer a different octave, a smaller pattern, or listening instead of singing when appropriate. Avoid breath-holding contests and extreme range exploration. Stop a task that produces pain, dizziness, or vocal strain.

Finish with a relevant transfer

Test one opening and one ending rather than running every song. Allow quiet recovery before going on. A singer who is hoarse or unwell should not be pushed to sing through it.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ *The routine suits today's repertoire*
- ☐ *Comfortable alternatives are available*
- ☐ *Recovery time is built into the routine*
- ☐ *The choir is prepared rather than fatigued*

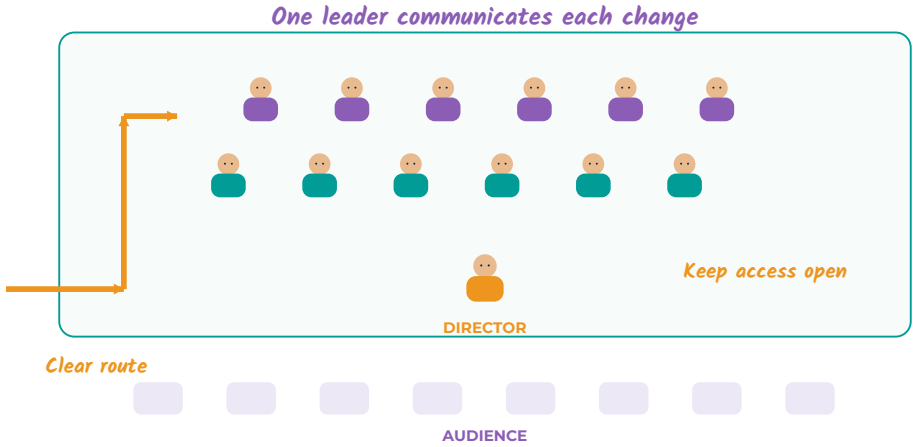
STAGE GUIDE 09

Make arrival and backstage instructions clear

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Send one concise set of instructions and confirm that people can access it.



Before you begin

Send one concise set of instructions and confirm that people can access it. Repeated messages with changing details are harder to follow than a dated final plan.

What to communicate

Give the venue address, arrival point, time, contact person, clothing guidance, music requirements, water and break arrangements, and the expected finish time. Include an accessible route and any necessary transport information.

What to check on arrival

Use a simple attendance list, confirm positions, locate facilities, and tell the choir when to be ready for soundcheck. Have a quiet way for someone to report a practical or wellbeing concern.

What to avoid

Do not block corridors, change the order informally, or allow competing instructions from several leaders. If a change is necessary, one nominated person communicates it clearly to everyone affected.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- [ ] A dated final arrival plan has been shared
- [ ] One person owns last-minute updates
- [ ] Attendance and practical concerns can be checked
- [ ] The choir knows where and when to wait

STAGE GUIDE 10

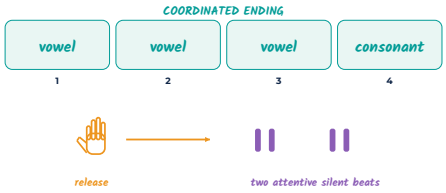
Rehearse the first and last ten seconds

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Openings and endings carry a lot of practical information.





Before you begin

Openings and endings carry a lot of practical information. They deserve focused rehearsal even when the middle of the piece is musically secure.

Opening sequence

Practise arrival at the ready position, eye contact, starting pitch, the director's preparation, and the first sound. Include an audience-like pause so singers learn to wait rather than anticipate.

Ending sequence

Agree the final vowel, consonant, release, and short moment of attention afterwards. The director then acknowledges the audience or gives the next transition. Comfortable stillness is enough; no one needs to freeze or hold their breath.

Test without reminders

Run the sequence once with spoken support and once without. If it breaks down, repair the precise cue or transition rather than repeating the complete song.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ *The opening works after an unpredictable pause*
- ☐ *The first vowel is coordinated*
- ☐ *The final consonant and release are aligned*
- ☐ *The next movement waits for the agreed cue*

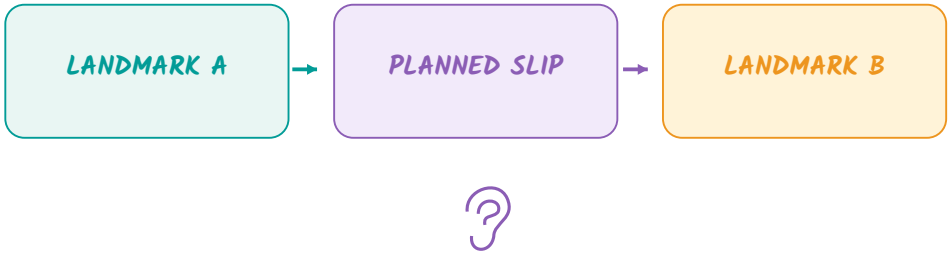
STAGE GUIDE II

Recover calmly when something changes

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

> **A recovery plan gives the choir useful options.**



Before you begin

A recovery plan gives the choir useful options. It is more practical than promising a mistake-free performance or telling people simply to be confident.

Missed entry or lost place

Listen, find the director, and rejoin at the next agreed landmark. Confirm the landmark's words and starting notes during rehearsal. Do not ask singers to scramble through pages while continuing uncertainly.

Practical interruption

If accompaniment or equipment fails, the director decides whether to continue, pause, or restart. The choir follows the visible stop or ready signal rather than several people giving instructions.

Someone needs to leave

Agree an unobstructed route and a responsible contact. Maintain the singer's privacy and do not insist that anyone remain on stage while unwell or uncomfortable.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- [ ] *Re-entry landmarks are marked*
- [ ] *Stop and ready signals are familiar*
- [ ] *One leader makes sequence decisions*
- [ ] *A practical exit and support contact are known*

Give feedback that improves the next performance

Stage-Ready Choir

Practical performance preparation / Use with your real event and rehearsal space

Debrief the event after a suitable pause.



Before you begin

Debrief the event after a suitable pause. Focus on what the choir can influence and separate a musical observation from a judgement about a person.

Start with evidence

Choose a concrete success, such as a coordinated opening after a long pause. Invite singers to describe what helped that success happen so it can be repeated.

Choose one next task

Locate one challenge by song, phrase, or transition. Decide whether the next action is musical practice, a clearer cue, an equipment change, or better instructions. Give the task an owner and a rehearsal date.

Close the loop

At the next meeting, test the planned change in context. Keep notes brief: what happened, what was changed, and whether it helped. Preserve useful habits instead of replacing everything after one difficult moment.

YOUR EVENT CHECK

- ☐ *One specific success is recorded*
- ☐ *One actionable challenge is selected*
- ☐ *The next task has an owner and time*
- ☐ *The change will be tested in a real run*

Your one-page event plan

Stage-Ready Choir

Complete before the final rehearsal / Share responsibilities with your team

Keep your programme, cues, arrangements, and next steps together.

DATE + VENUE

ARRIVAL / SOUNDCHECK / START

CONTACT + COMMUNICATION OWNER

PROGRAMME + CUES

1.
2.
3.
4.

SKETCH YOUR FORMATION + ROUTE

NEXT ACTION / OWNER / DEADLINE

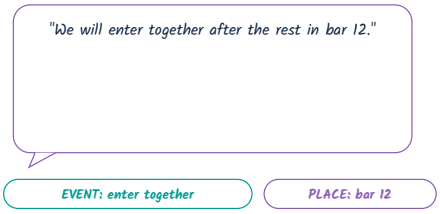
RE-ENTRY LANDMARKS + BACKUP PLAN

BONUS 03

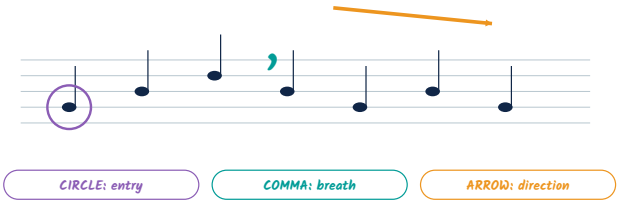
30 COMPLETE REHEARSAL PLANS

Eight 30-minute, eight 45-minute, eight 60-minute, and six 90-minute plans with clear targets and checks.

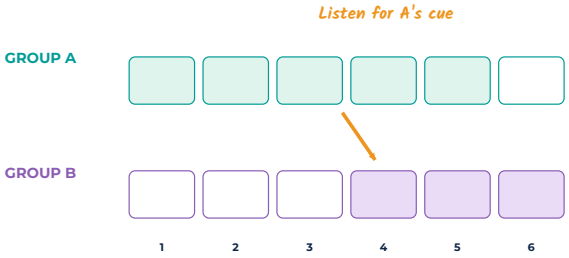




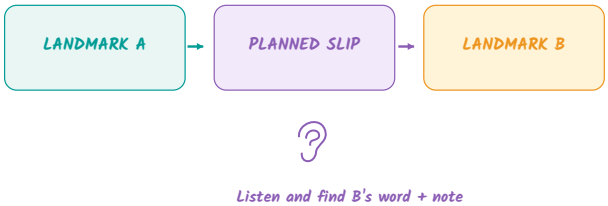
ONE TARGET



CLEAR MARKS



LISTEN + ENTER



RECOVER

Illustrated methods you can understand, try, and use in real music.

A plan is a route, not a stopwatch

Pick a useful target

Each plan names a group context, a practical goal, a warm-up activity, two focused tasks, a repertoire transfer, and an observable outcome. The activity numbers refer to the main 120-activity collection, included with the complete bundle.

Read the referenced pages first

The shortened instructions in these plans make the sequence usable at a glance. Use the main activity page for the complete three-step method, adaptation, and success criterion. Have the pages ready before the choir arrives.

Treat the rest block as real recovery

The middle block is non-singing time: drink water as needed, listen, read the text, check a cue, or discuss a practical point. Longer sessions need additional pauses within the blocks whenever the group needs them.

Adapt rather than overfill

If one task needs more time, reduce a later repetition or choose a shorter excerpt. Do not remove rest to keep a timetable. The final check is more useful than completing every planned repetition.



Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

PLAN 01

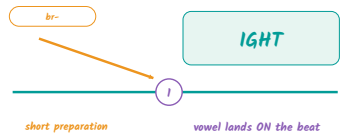
First Meeting, Shared Signals

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / New mixed choir / Prepare activities 031, 008 and 058

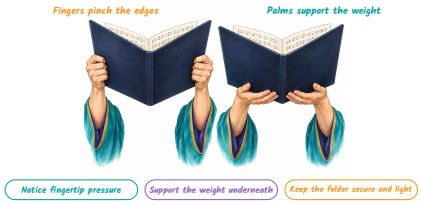
Establish a welcoming start and a dependable first cue.

PREPARE / Activity 031



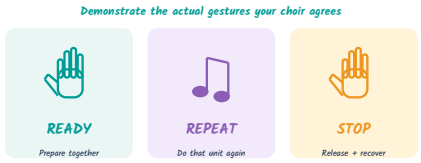
Consonant Launch Pad

FOCUS A / Activity 008



Hands Without Grip

FOCUS B / Activity 058



Group Signal Agreement

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

New mixed choir. Establish a welcoming start and a dependable first cue. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 031, Consonant Launch Pad. Speak the text on four beats, noticing the short consonant before each vowel. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 008, Hands Without Grip. Stop score gripping from spreading effort into the upper body. Support its weight with the palms or a stand so the fingertips do less work.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 058, Group Signal Agreement. Create clear shared signals that reduce uncertainty. Practise responding to a mixed sequence of the gestures with silence or a short spoken response.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use a familiar two-phrase song; agree the ready and stop gestures before trying its first entrance. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

Everyone locates the page and responds together to the preparation. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 02

A Clear Unison Beginning

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Beginner ensemble / Prepare activities 021, 001 and 061

Match a comfortable opening note and keep its first vowel together.

PREPARE / Activity 021



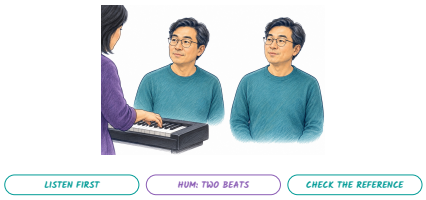
Hum to Open Vowel

FOCUS A / Activity 001



Balanced Feet

FOCUS B / Activity 061



One-Note Landing

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Beginner ensemble. Match a comfortable opening note and keep its first vowel together. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 021, Hum to Open Vowel. Hum 'mm' softly for two beats with the jaw easy; rest after each attempt. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 001, Balanced Feet. Find a stable stance without locking the knees. Shift weight gently forward and back, then settle where neither heels nor toes grip.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 061, One-Note Landing. Match a comfortable reference pitch after listening. Hum it gently for two beats, stop, and hear the reference again.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Work on one unison phrase; establish its reference note before every attempt. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

The first note matches the reference without a rushed start. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 03

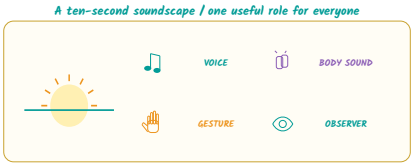
Rhythm Without the Rush

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Youth or adult choir / Prepare activities 053, 041 and 044

Keep the beat steady through one rest.

PREPARE / Activity 053



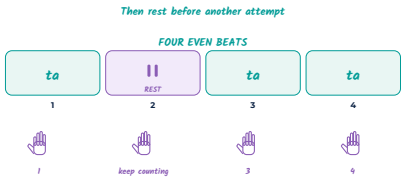
Sound Postcard

FOCUS A / Activity 041



Find the Shared Pulse

FOCUS B / Activity 044



Rest Is an Action

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Youth or adult choir. Keep the beat steady through one rest. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 053, Sound Postcard. Each group chooses a place such as a garden or station and invents a quiet ten-second soundscape. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 041, Find the Shared Pulse. Establish a steady beat before working on rhythm. Continue tapping through four silent beats without changing speed.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 044, Rest Is an Action. Count a silence actively and enter after it. Repeat using 'loo' on a comfortable note; keep the rest silent rather than inhaling noisily on it.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Select a short passage with a rest; speak its rhythm before restoring notes. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

The re-entry after the rest is accurate twice in context. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 04

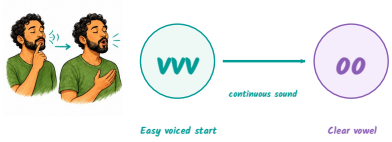
Words the Room Can Hear

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Text-focused rehearsal / Prepare activities 026, 034 and 032

Make one important lyric line understandable.

PREPARE / Activity 026



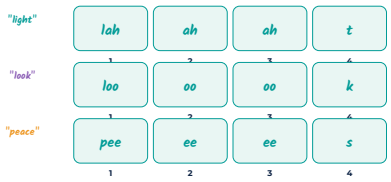
Soft 'V' Bridge

FOCUS A / Activity 034



Slow-Speech Precision

FOCUS B / Activity 032



Final Consonant Appointment

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Text-focused rehearsal. Make one important lyric line understandable. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 026, Soft 'V' Bridge. Model a gentle 'vvv-oo' for two beats, using little volume and no pressure at the lips. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 034, Slow-Speech Precision. Clarify text without tightening the mouth or speeding up. Choose the two least clear words and practise their syllables separately, using only necessary movement.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 032, Final Consonant Appointment. Agree exactly when a final consonant will be heard. Repeat with 'look' and 'peace', keeping the vowel alive until the agreed release.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Choose two unclear words and a final consonant; work at a conversational volume first. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

A listener can repeat the line's words correctly. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 05

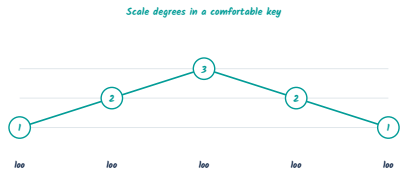
A Gentle Seated Rehearsal

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Seated or mixed-mobility group / Prepare activities 022, 004 and 065

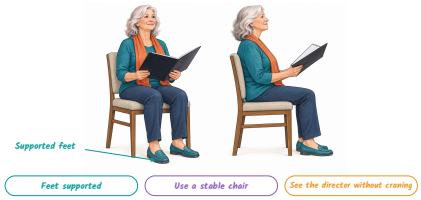
Support comfortable participation and a connected vowel line.

PREPARE / Activity 022



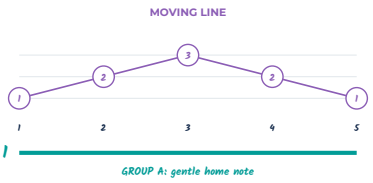
Three-Note Neighbourhood

FOCUS A / Activity 004



Seated Singer Setup

FOCUS B / Activity 065



Drone and Melody

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Seated or mixed-mobility group. Support comfortable participation and a connected vowel line. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 022, Three-Note Neighbourhood. Model scale degrees 1-2-3-2-1 on 'loo', one note per beat; let singers listen once. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 004, Seated Singer Setup. Keep a useful singing position when standing is not practical. Look ahead at an imaginary director and breathe normally for two cycles.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 065, Drone and Melody. Hear a melody against a quiet sustained reference. Stop, breathe normally, and exchange roles; nobody must sustain beyond comfort.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use short phrases with planned recovery; adjust score height before increasing demands. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

Singers can watch the director and finish the chosen phrase comfortably. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 06

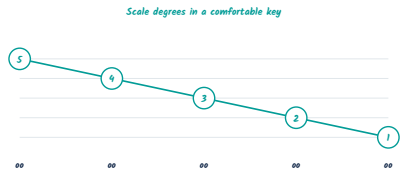
Children's First Shared Phrase

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Children's choir / Prepare activities 023, 051 and 073

Build attentive listening and a short, comfortable response.

PREPARE / Activity 023



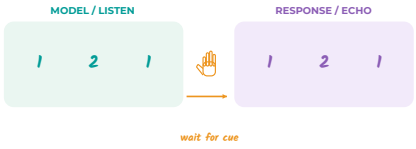
Gentle Descending Five

FOCUS A / Activity 051



Name and Note Circle

FOCUS B / Activity 073



Listen Before You Echo

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Children's choir. Build attentive listening and a short, comfortable response. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 023, Gentle Descending Five. Model 5-4-3-2-1 on 'oo' in a range already comfortable for the choir. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 051, Name and Note Circle. Learn names while giving everyone a low-pressure first response. Invite willing singers to offer a spoken name; the group echoes each without judging pitch.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 073, Listen Before You Echo. Delay the response until the whole model has been heard. Model a short phrase while the hand stays raised; release the echo cue after one silent beat.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use a familiar song with two short lines; keep individual participation optional. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

The group waits for the echo cue and enters together. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 07

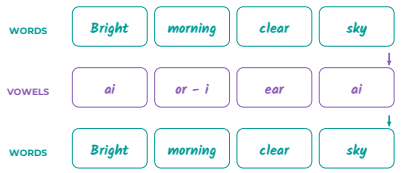
Ending Together

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Church or community choir / Prepare activities 033, 020 and 109

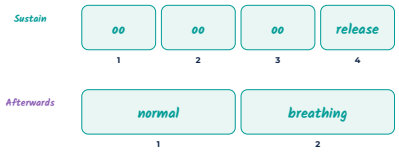
Align the last word and the visible finish.

PREPARE / Activity 033



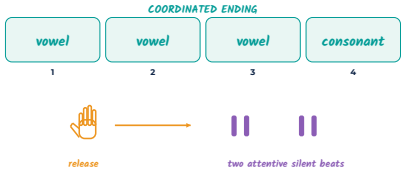
Vowel-Only Text

FOCUS A / Activity 020



Unhurried Final Release

FOCUS B / Activity 109



Final Consonant to Stillness

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Church or community choir. Align the last word and the visible finish. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 033, Vowel-Only Text. Speak the words naturally, then identify the main vowel in each syllable. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 020, Unhurried Final Release. Finish a note together while allowing an easy recovery. Release the vowel and allow normal breathing immediately afterwards.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 109, Final Consonant to Stillness. Finish a piece with coordinated sound and a calm visible ending. Sing the ending, then remain comfortably attentive for two silent beats without freezing the body.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Rehearse the final two bars, then reconnect the preceding phrase. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

There is one clear release followed by attentive silence. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 08

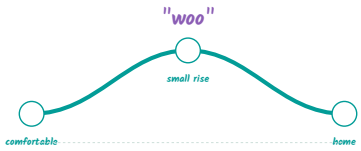
A Useful Midweek Reset

Rehearsals in Harmony

30 minutes / Busy volunteer choir / Prepare activities 024, 091 and 098

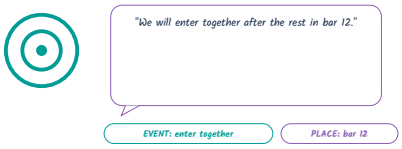
Solve one priority without restarting the whole programme.

PREPARE / Activity 024



Small-Range Glide

FOCUS A / Activity 091



Rehearsal Goal in One Sentence

FOCUS B / Activity 098



Transition Without Talk

3m	4m	6m	3m	6m	5m	3m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–03 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Busy volunteer choir. Solve one priority without restarting the whole programme. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

03–07 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 024, Small-Range Glide. Model a gentle 'woo' moving a small distance up and back down; avoid the extremes of your range. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

07–13 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 091, Rehearsal Goal in One Sentence. Give the group a clear, achievable target for the session. Let singers locate that point and describe what success would sound like.

13–16 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

16–22 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 098, Transition Without Talk. Move between activities with clear instructions and little lost time. Give ten quiet seconds to find the place, then check readiness with a visible signal.

22–27 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Run a short passage, choose its most disruptive issue, and repair only that feature. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

27–30 MIN / Check and close

The improvement survives when the full passage returns. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 09

Breath Plans That Fit Words

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Mixed choir / Prepare activities 025, 013 and 019

Choose breaths that support the text and the group.

PREPARE / Activity 025



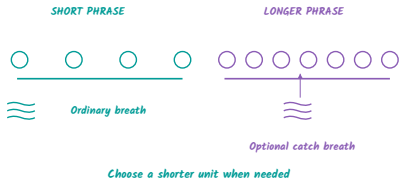
Vowel Colour Circle

FOCUS A / Activity 013



Breath Mark Detective

FOCUS B / Activity 019



Two-Phrase Breath Map

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Mixed choir. Choose breaths that support the text and the group. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 025, Vowel Colour Circle. Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one note, changing vowel on each beat and releasing on beat four. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 013, Breath Mark Detective. Choose sensible breath locations in actual repertoire. Mark one shared breath location that respects both the words and the musical phrase.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 019, Two-Phrase Breath Map. Plan different breaths for short and longer musical ideas. Rehearse the shorter phrase with an ordinary breath; rehearse the longer one at a manageable tempo with an optional marked catch breath.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Read two contrasting phrases, mark breathing places, then sing them in order. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

No marked breath splits a word and the second phrase begins comfortably. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 10

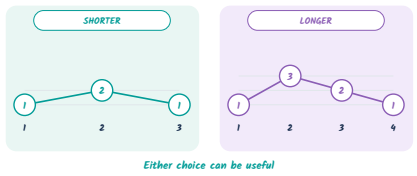
Learning a New Melodic Cell

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Beginner or developing choir / Prepare activities 029, 063 and 066

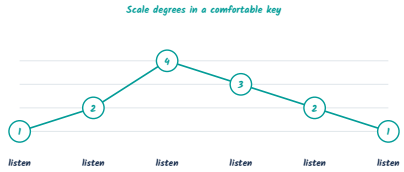
Hear and reproduce a short recurring pitch pattern.

PREPARE / Activity 029



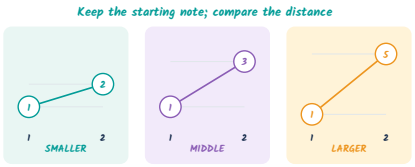
Echo Then Choose

FOCUS A / Activity 063



Melody Contour Map

FOCUS B / Activity 066



Interval Echo Pairs

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Beginner or developing choir. Hear and reproduce a short recurring pitch pattern. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 029, Echo Then Choose. Model both patterns on 'mee' and have everyone listen before singing. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 063, Melody Contour Map. Connect the shape of a melody to its sound. Draw a simple line showing the direction changes; compare it with the model.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 066, Interval Echo Pairs. Remember the distance between two notes without guessing from text. Let the group echo and describe whether the distance feels small, medium, or larger.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Extract the song's recurring three- or four-note cell and restore it in context. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

The cell is correct at two different places in the score. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN II

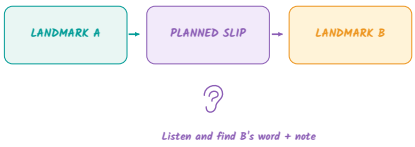
Diction Through a Page Turn

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Score-reading ensemble / Prepare activities 106, 005 and 035

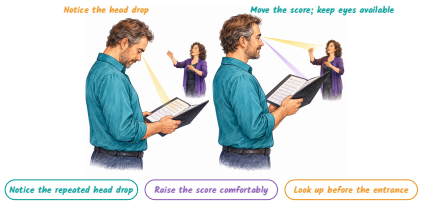
Keep pronunciation and attention through a practical transition.

PREPARE / Activity 106



Mistake Recovery Anchor

FOCUS A / Activity 005



Score at Eye Level

FOCUS B / Activity 035



One Word, Three Vowels

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Score-reading ensemble. Keep pronunciation and attention through a practical transition. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 106, Mistake Recovery Anchor. Choose two safe re-entry landmarks and confirm the starting words and notes for each. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 005, Score at Eye Level. Reduce repeated head dropping while reading music. Alternate looking at the first word and the director's hand for four silent cues.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 035, One Word, Three Vowels. Agree a shared vowel shape for one problematic word. Choose the version that best fits the song's language and style without mocking accents.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Choose the line crossing a page turn; agree a shared vowel before rehearsing the turn. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

The new page starts on cue with understandable text. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 12

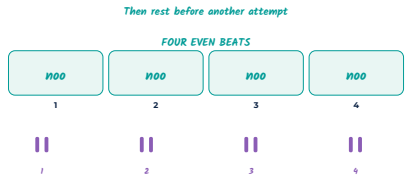
Pulse, Meter, and a Confident Entry

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Youth choir / Prepare activities 028, 047 and 048

Keep meter steady while placing one offbeat entrance.

PREPARE / Activity 028



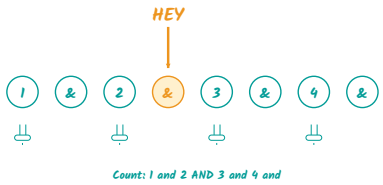
Gentle Repeated Notes

FOCUS A / Activity 047



Walk the Meter

FOCUS B / Activity 048



Offbeat Entry Builder

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Youth choir. Keep meter steady while placing one offbeat entrance. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 028, Gentle Repeated Notes. Speak 'noo, noo, noo, noo' conversationally on four beats. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 047, Walk the Meter. Feel the difference between groups of two and three. Change to down-side-up for 'ONE two three', keeping each beat evenly spaced.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 048, Offbeat Entry Builder. Enter accurately between two steady beats. Say 'hey' only on the 'and' after beat two, keeping the beat in the hand.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Speak the entry against a tapped count, then restore the melody slowly. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

The entry lands between beats without shifting the following pulse. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 13

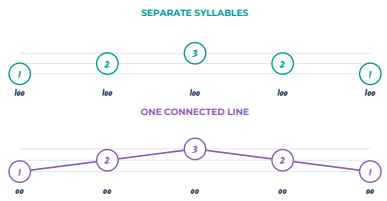
Listening Across Sections

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Two-part ensemble / Prepare activities 027, 096 and 097

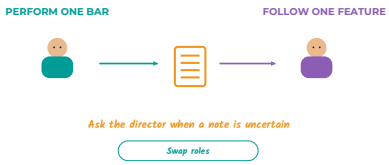
Make a section handover audible and well balanced.

PREPARE / Activity 027



Legato Beads

FOCUS A / Activity 096



Partner Part Check

FOCUS B / Activity 097



Balanced Section Entry

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Two-part ensemble. Make a section handover audible and well balanced. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 027, Legato Beads. Sing the pattern on separate 'loo' syllables to establish its notes. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 096, Partner Part Check. Hear a part accurately without turning peers into judges. Singer A performs the bar or speaks its rhythm while B follows the score; exchange roles.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 097, Balanced Section Entry. Keep a new section from overpowering a continuing line. Add the entering group at a gentler volume and listen for the continuing text.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Work on two overlapping phrases; the new section listens before joining. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

Both lines remain clear during the overlap. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 14

Remembering a Familiar Song

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Community choir / Prepare activities 030, 076 and 078

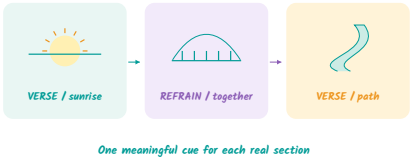
Watch the director without losing the next text landmark.

PREPARE / Activity 030



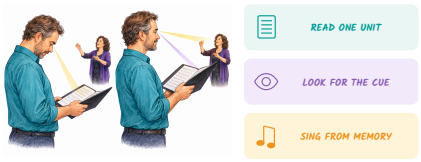
Warm-Up to Song

FOCUS A / Activity 076



Lyric Landmark Map

FOCUS B / Activity 078



Score-to-Eyes Transfer

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Community choir. Watch the director without losing the next text landmark. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 030, Warm-Up to Song. Isolate the three-note rise and sing it gently on 'oo' at a comfortable pitch. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 076, Lyric Landmark Map. Recall a longer song through meaningful section cues. Sing section openings while looking only at that landmark list.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 078, Score-to-Eyes Transfer. Remember a small unit long enough to watch the director. Look up and sing the same unit from memory, allowing a glance back afterwards.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Map section openings, then rehearse short units from memory with planned glances. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

Singers find two internal landmarks without restarting the song. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN IS

Text With One Intention

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Church choir / Prepare activities 021, 081 and 083

Give one phrase an agreed communicative direction.

PREPARE / Activity 021
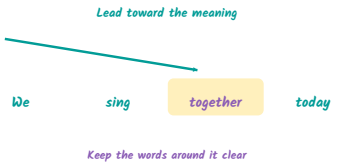


Hum to Open Vowel

FOCUS A / Activity 081



One Phrase, One Intention

FOCUS B / Activity 083



Phrase Destination

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Church choir. Give one phrase an agreed communicative direction. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 021, Hum to Open Vowel. Hum 'mm' softly for two beats with the jaw easy; rest after each attempt. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 081, One Phrase, One Intention. Give a lyric a specific communicative purpose. Speak it to an imaginary listener without changing the words.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 083, Phrase Destination. Shape a line toward one meaningful word. Sing toward that word with a small sense of direction, then release the remaining text naturally.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Choose a central word and a suitable intention; test them with volunteer listeners. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

Listeners identify the intended message in the second attempt. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 16

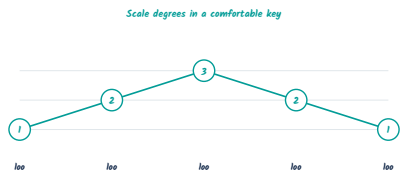
Welcoming and Reconnecting

Rehearsals in Harmony

45 minutes / Choir with new members / Prepare activities 022, 057 and 055

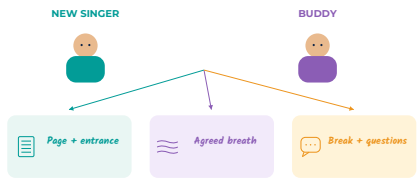
Support newcomers while improving one ensemble detail.

PREPARE / Activity 022



Three-Note Neighbourhood

FOCUS A / Activity 057



New Singer Buddy Map

FOCUS B / Activity 055



One Helpful Thing

4m	6m	9m	4m	9m	9m	4m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–04 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Choir with new members. Support newcomers while improving one ensemble detail. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

04–10 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 022, Three-Note Neighbourhood. Model scale degrees 1-2-3-2-1 on 'loo', one note per beat; let singers listen once. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

10–19 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 057, New Singer Buddy Map. Give a newcomer practical help without testing them publicly. Ask the pair to locate the first entrance and one agreed breath together.

19–23 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

23–32 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 055, One Helpful Thing. Build useful peer feedback without personal criticism. After the passage, partners describe one specific thing they heard that supported that focus.

32–41 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Pair practical score support with a familiar passage and descriptive feedback. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

41–45 MIN / Check and close

New singers know where to enter and the group can name one improvement. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 17

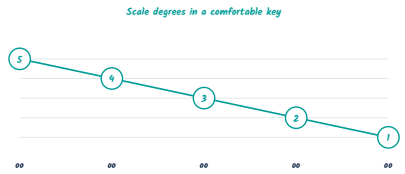
From Notes to a Complete Phrase

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Developing mixed choir / Prepare activities 023, 094 and 085

Connect rhythm, notes, text, and a comfortable dynamic shape.

PREPARE / Activity 023



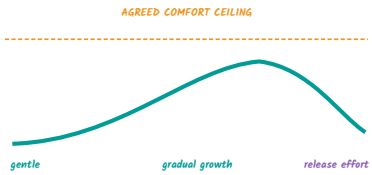
Gentle Descending Five

FOCUS A / Activity 094



Three-Pass Repair

FOCUS B / Activity 085



Crescendo With a Ceiling

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Developing mixed choir. Connect rhythm, notes, text, and a comfortable dynamic shape. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 023, Gentle Descending Five. Model 5-4-3-2-1 on 'oo' in a range already comfortable for the choir. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 094, Three-Pass Repair. Use successive repetitions for different purposes. Pass two restores notes on one vowel, checking the part without text pressure.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 085, Crescendo With a Ceiling. Increase intensity gradually within a comfortable volume range. Begin gently and increase a little over four beats without exceeding that level.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use a four-bar passage; move from spoken rhythm to one vowel, then restore text and meaning. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

Each layer remains reliable in the complete passage. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 18

Three-Part Listening Session

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Experienced or supported three-part choir / Prepare activities 025, 068 and 077

Hear each chord part and rejoin after silence.

PREPARE / Activity 025



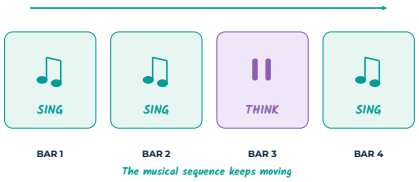
Vowel Colour Circle

FOCUS A / Activity 068



Chord Listening Triangle

FOCUS B / Activity 077



Silent Singing Window

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Experienced or supported three-part choir. Hear each chord part and rejoin after silence. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 025, Vowel Colour Circle. Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one note, changing vowel on each beat and releasing on beat four. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 068, Chord Listening Triangle. Balance three chord tones by listening across the ensemble. Build the chord one group at a time at gentle volume, with short holds and normal breaths.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 077, Silent Singing Window. Keep the musical sequence moving during a brief silent passage. Continue the next bar silently in your mind while watching the beat, then sing the final bar aloud.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Establish short chord tones separately and practise one planned silent bar. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

Parts return at the expected pitch and time without overpowering each other. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 19

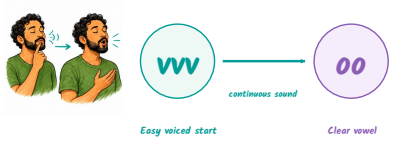
Sharper Text, Less Effort

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Adult choir / Prepare activities 026, 036 and 038

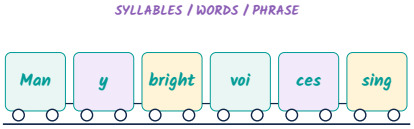
Clarify quick syllables and coordinate one moving vowel.

PREPARE / Activity 026



Soft 'V' Bridge

FOCUS A / Activity 036



Syllable Train

FOCUS B / Activity 038



Diphthong Landing

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Adult choir. Clarify quick syllables and coordinate one moving vowel. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 026, Soft 'V' Bridge. Model a gentle 'vvv-oo' for two beats, using little volume and no pressure at the lips. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 036, Syllable Train. Align syllables in a quick text passage. Group the syllables into meaningful words while keeping their places in the rhythm.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 038, Diphthong Landing. Coordinate a moving vowel in a sustained English word. Sing the first part of the vowel for three beats, moving gently to its ending on beat four.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Choose a busy text phrase and a sustained diphthong; slow each before combining. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

No syllable disappears and the vowel change happens together. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 20

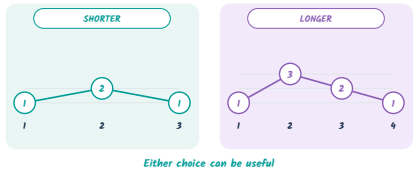
Memory With Reliable Restarts

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Choir preparing memorized music / Prepare activities 029, 072 and 080

Recall lyrics and restart from internal landmarks.

PREPARE / Activity 029



Either choice can be useful

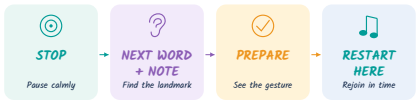
Echo Then Choose

FOCUS A / Activity 072

READ	We	sing	together	today
HIDE	We	sing	_____	today
RECALL	We	____	together	_____

Missing Word Rehearsal

FOCUS B / Activity 080



Recall and Rebuild

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Choir preparing memorized music. Recall lyrics and restart from internal landmarks. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 029, Echo Then Choose. Model both patterns on 'mee' and have everyone listen before singing. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 072, Missing Word Rehearsal. Retrieve important lyric words without depending on the page. Hide one key word and let the choir supply it in the spoken rhythm.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 080, Recall and Rebuild. Recover a passage after an interruption without starting from the beginning. Give a clear preparation and restart exactly at that point.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use missing-word rehearsal on one verse and mark two safe restart points. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

The group resumes from either landmark with the correct first words. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 21

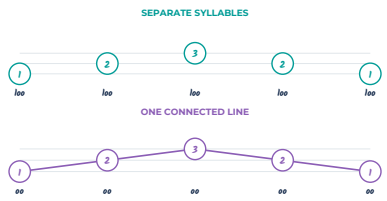
Interpretation Through Listening

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Mixed community choir / Prepare activities 027, 086 and 090

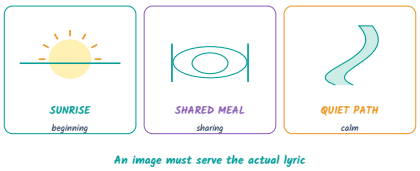
Make a lyric's story understandable to listeners.

PREPARE / Activity 027



Legato Beads

FOCUS A / Activity 086



An image must serve the actual lyric

Text Image Gallery

FOCUS B / Activity 090



Listener's Story Test

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Mixed community choir. Make a lyric's story understandable to listeners. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 027, Legato Beads. Sing the pattern on separate 'loo' syllables to establish its notes. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 086, Text Image Gallery. Use a concrete image to clarify a lyric's meaning. Small groups choose one and explain how it relates to the actual words.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 090, Listener's Story Test. Check whether an interpretation communicates a clear narrative. Sing once and ask listeners to describe what they understood from the text and musical delivery.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Try one concrete image and test the result without telling listeners the intended message first. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

The revised take communicates the intended meaning more clearly. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 22

A Practical Service Rehearsal

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Church choir / Prepare activities 110, 102 and 105

Coordinate the service opening, transitions, and follow-up.

PREPARE / Activity 110



Performance Debrief That Helps

FOCUS A / Activity 102



First Ten Seconds

FOCUS B / Activity 105



Between-Song Reset



ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Church choir. Coordinate the service opening, transitions, and follow-up. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 110, Performance Debrief That Helps. Ask the choir to name one musical success supported by a concrete example. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 102, First Ten Seconds. Make the beginning of a performance predictable. Add the opening phrase once, then stop and reset rather than continuing the whole song.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 105, Between-Song Reset. Handle the silence between pieces without confusion. Change pages or positions during an agreed quiet interval; check that nobody is left behind.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use the actual running order; rehearse the gap between two items as carefully as the notes. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

The next item starts without uncertainty about page, pitch, or cue. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 23

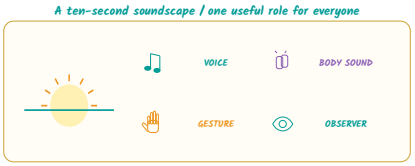
Young Singers, Shared Ownership

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Children or youth choir / Prepare activities 053, 074 and 111

Combine attention practice with a bounded creative task.

PREPARE / Activity 053



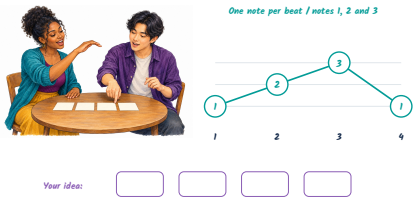
Sound Postcard

FOCUS A / Activity 074



Two Cues, Two Responses

FOCUS B / Activity 111



Four-Note Composer

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Children or youth choir. Combine attention practice with a bounded creative task. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 053, Sound Postcard. Each group chooses a place such as a garden or station and invents a quiet ten-second soundscape. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 074, Two Cues, Two Responses. Hold two simple musical instructions in working memory. Show six mixed cues slowly, allowing one clear response to each.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity III, Four-Note Composer. Create a short melody within a clear musical boundary. Pairs invent a different phrase, choosing a comfortable starting pitch and allowing a rest.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Use short rehearsal blocks; create a four-beat three-note phrase in pairs and connect it to a song. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

The group follows current cue meanings and repeats its created phrase accurately. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 24

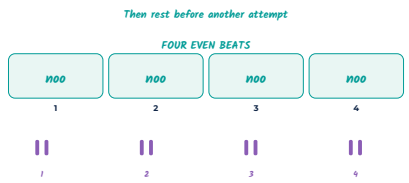
Choir Independence Check

Rehearsals in Harmony

60 minutes / Established volunteer ensemble / Prepare activities 028, 095 and 099

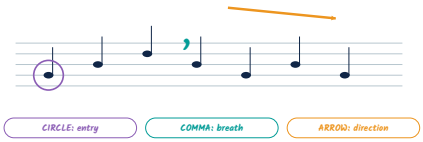
Use clear score marks and productive section reports.

PREPARE / Activity 028



Gentle Repeated Notes

FOCUS A / Activity 095



Rehearsal Marking Key

FOCUS B / Activity 099



Two-Minute Section Report

5m	8m	12m	5m	12m	13m	5m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–05 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Established volunteer ensemble. Use clear score marks and productive section reports. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

05–13 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 028, Gentle Repeated Notes. Speak 'noo, noo, noo, noo' conversationally on four beats. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

13–25 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 095, Rehearsal Marking Key. Make score annotations clear enough to use next week. Mark one example of each in the same passage and check that everyone can locate them.

25–30 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

30–42 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 099, Two-Minute Section Report. Turn section work into useful information for the full choir. Ask a spokesperson to report the solution, remaining difficulty, and exact bar number in under a minute.

42–55 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Give each section one defined task with a bar number; test the proposed solution in full choir. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

55–60 MIN / Check and close

Every section reports one finding that leads to an audible improvement. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 25

Performance Sequence Rehearsal

Rehearsals in Harmony

90 minutes / Choir nearing a concert / Prepare activities 102, 101 and 105

Make arrival and between-song transitions dependable.

PREPARE / Activity 102



First Ten Seconds

FOCUS A / Activity 101



Walk-On and Settle

FOCUS B / Activity 105



Between-Song Reset

8m	10m	17m	8m	17m	23m	7m
ARRIVE	PREPARE	FOCUS A	RECOVER	FOCUS B	TRANSFER	CHECK

00–08 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Choir nearing a concert. Make arrival and between-song transitions dependable. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

08–18 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 102, First Ten Seconds. Practise the silent sequence: ready position, eye contact, preparation, and entrance. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

18–35 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 101, Walk-On and Settle. Enter the performance space safely and become ready together. Arrive at places, face the director, and allow a quiet moment to settle without a rigid pose.

35–43 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

43–60 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 105, Between-Song Reset. Handle the silence between pieces without confusion. Change pages or positions during an agreed quiet interval; check that nobody is left behind.

60–83 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Run a small set in order with planned pauses; separately repair only the highest-priority transition. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

83–90 MIN / Check and close

The sequence works without spoken reminders between pieces. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 26

Room and Amplification Session

Rehearsals in Harmony

90 minutes / Amplified church or community choir / Prepare activities 025, 103 and 107

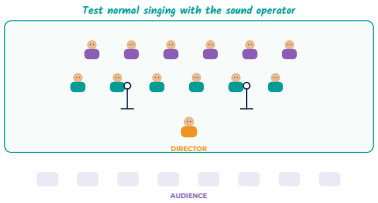
Find a clear setup while preserving normal singing effort.

PREPARE / Activity 025



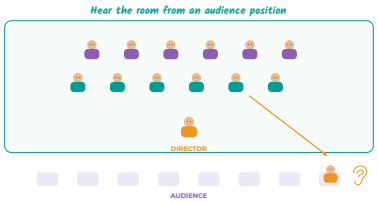
Vowel Colour Circle

FOCUS A / Activity 103



Microphone Distance Check

FOCUS B / Activity 107



Acoustic Listening Pass

8m	10m	17m	8m	17m	23m	7m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–08 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Amplified church or community choir. Find a clear setup while preserving normal singing effort. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

08–18 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 025, Vowel Colour Circle. Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one note, changing vowel on each beat and releasing on beat four. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

18–35 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 103, Microphone Distance Check. Find a practical amplified setup without singing louder to compensate. Try the planned positions without blocking faces or access routes; do not handle equipment without permission.

35–43 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

43–60 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 107, Acoustic Listening Pass. Adapt balance to a room before changing vocal effort. Ask about text clarity, balance, and room resonance rather than whether it is 'loud enough'.

60–83 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Coordinate with the sound operator; test a representative passage and change placement before demanding volume. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

83–90 MIN / Check and close

Text and balance improve without singers pushing for loudness. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 27

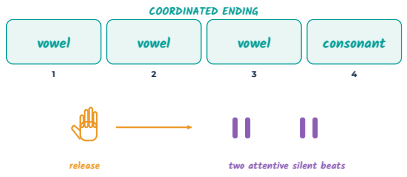
Dress Rehearsal With Recovery

Rehearsals in Harmony

90 minutes / Performance-ready ensemble / Prepare activities 109, 108 and 106

Find practical snags and practise recovery landmarks.

PREPARE / Activity 109



Final Consonant to Stillness

FOCUS A / Activity 108



Dress Rehearsal Checklist Run

FOCUS B / Activity 106



Mistake Recovery Anchor

8m	10m	17m	8m	17m	23m	7m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–08 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Performance-ready ensemble. Find practical snags and practise recovery landmarks. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

08–18 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 109, Final Consonant to Stillness. Agree when the final vowel, consonant, and conductor release occur. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

18–35 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 108, Dress Rehearsal Checklist Run. Test practical readiness using a short performance excerpt. Perform one opening, one page turn, and one ending exactly as planned.

35–43 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

43–60 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 106, Mistake Recovery Anchor. Continue after a slip using a planned musical landmark. The director briefly stops one group at a planned point while the others continue.

60–83 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Run one short set with clothing, folders, and route arrangements; give every practical issue an owner. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

83–90 MIN / Check and close

The group can recover from a planned slip and complete the final release together. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 28

Creative Community Programme

Rehearsals in Harmony

90 minutes / Mixed-experience community choir / Prepare activities 081, 113 and 118

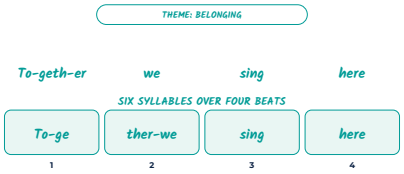
Create a concise original introduction and expressive song sequence.

PREPARE / Activity 081



One Phrase, One Intention

FOCUS A / Activity 113



Lyric Seed Workshop

FOCUS B / Activity 118



Community Dedication Line

8m	10m	17m	8m	17m	23m	7m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–08 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Mixed-experience community choir. Create a concise original introduction and expressive song sequence. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

08–18 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 081, One Phrase, One Intention. Read the line and choose one intention, such as reassuring, inviting, or celebrating. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

18–35 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 113, Lyric Seed Workshop. Write a brief original lyric that fits a simple rhythm. Write a line of six to eight syllables, checking that its meaning is clear when spoken.

35–43 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

43–60 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 118, Community Dedication Line. Create a short spoken or sung introduction that suits the audience. Write one clear welcoming sentence and test it aloud for length and tone.

60–83 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Write a short inclusive dedication, test its length, and rehearse its transition into the song. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

83–90 MIN / Check and close

The introduction suits the audience and leads into a secure musical cue. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 29

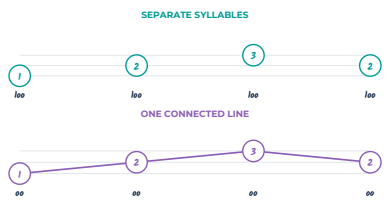
Detailed Musical Repair Workshop

Rehearsals in Harmony

90 minutes / Experienced choir / Prepare activities 087, 092 and 070

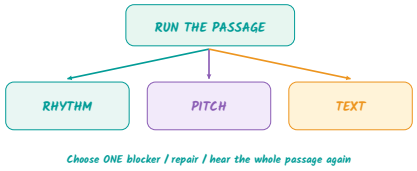
Solve one closing-pitch issue and one articulation decision.

PREPARE / Activity 087



Articulation Contrast

FOCUS A / Activity 092



Trouble Spot Triage

FOCUS B / Activity 070



Tune the Phrase Ending

8m	10m	17m	8m	17m	23m	7m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–08 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Experienced choir. Solve one closing-pitch issue and one articulation decision. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

08–18 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 087, Articulation Contrast. Sing the phrase smoothly on 'loo', then repeat with gently separated syllables. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

18–35 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 092, Trouble Spot Triage. Choose a useful rehearsal priority instead of correcting everything. Choose one issue that affects the most singers or prevents progress, separating rhythm, pitch, and text.

35–43 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

43–60 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 070, Tune the Phrase Ending. Stabilize a closing note within its musical context. Sing backward from the ending in small units: last word, last two words, then the full closing line.

60–83 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Record exact trouble spots in the score; compare a focused repair with the full contextual run. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

83–90 MIN / Check and close

The ending stays in tune and the chosen articulation is consistent. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

PLAN 30

End-of-Cycle Review and Next Steps

Rehearsals in Harmony

90 minutes / Any established ensemble / Prepare activities 100, 110 and 119

Review progress, test one arrangement idea, and plan the next cycle.

PREPARE / Activity 100



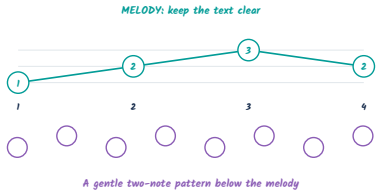
Next-Rehearsal Bridge

FOCUS A / Activity 110



Performance Debrief That Helps

FOCUS B / Activity 119



Arrange a Gentle Ostinato

8m	10m	17m	8m	17m	23m	7m

ARRIVE / PREPARE / FOCUS A / RECOVER / FOCUS B / TRANSFER / CHECK

00–08 MIN / Arrive and name the target

Any established ensemble. Review progress, test one arrangement idea, and plan the next cycle. Confirm the exact score location and one success criterion.

08–18 MIN / Prepare the sound

Activity 100, Next-Rehearsal Bridge. Name the strongest improvement from today's final run and the next unresolved task. Then apply its remaining steps with normal recovery pauses.

18–35 MIN / Focused task A

Activity 110, Performance Debrief That Helps. Use a performance experience to choose one constructive improvement. Choose one challenge the group can influence, locating the exact moment rather than blaming a person.

35–43 MIN / Recover and listen

Pause singing. Allow normal breathing and water as needed. Read the upcoming text or listen to the director's short model; identify one useful cue.

43–60 MIN / Focused task B

Activity 119, Arrange a Gentle Ostinato. Support a melody with a short repeating pattern. Practise it quietly for four beats, then rest while another group tries the melody.

60–83 MIN / Transfer into repertoire

Compare a current passage with its earlier rehearsal target; try a quiet ostinato only where harmony permits. Work in short attempts with listening and recovery between them.

83–90 MIN / Check and close

The group identifies a real gain and writes one precise next-rehearsal task. Write the next page, bar, and one practical task for the following rehearsal.

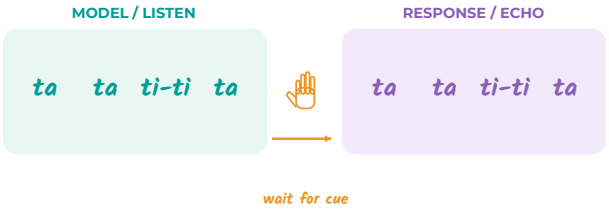
BONUS 04

40 EXPRESS WARM-UPS

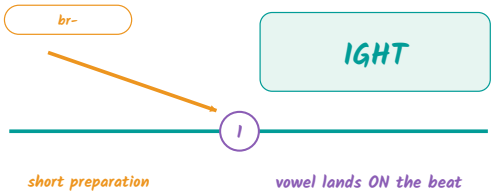
Fourteen five-minute, thirteen ten-minute, and thirteen fifteen-minute sequences for specific rehearsal needs.



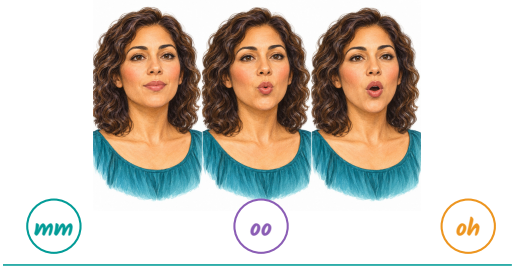
EASY AIR



STEADY PULSE



CLEAR WORDS



GENTLE SOUND

Illustrated methods you can understand, try, and use in real music.

Choose the time you actually have

Five, ten, or fifteen minutes

Sequences 01-14 take five minutes. Sequences 15-27 take ten minutes. Sequences 28-40 take fifteen minutes. Each has a specific context and a four-block plan, so a short warm-up still leads to something useful.

Timing is teaching time

Include the demonstration, listening, recovery breaths, rests, and one brief observation inside every block. Never sing a small pattern continuously for its full allotted time. Stop or shorten a task that becomes tiring.

Pitch and choice

Use a comfortable middle-range starting note. Numbered patterns are major scale degrees: 1 is home. A different octave, a smaller pattern, speech, or listening is always an option. Singers who are hoarse, tired, or uncomfortable should not be pushed to sing.

When time is cut further

Keep a calm preparation, one easy sound or spoken task, and one real entrance. Drop extra repetitions before dropping the recovery time. These sequences are rehearsal preparation, not treatment for a voice problem.

Choose a useful aim. Model the task. Notice a real result.

WARM-UP 01

Gentle Arrival

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Settle a group that arrives rushed.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Release shoulder effort and find supported feet.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Speak a greeting after an ordinary breath.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Hum one comfortable note, rest, then open to 'oo'.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Sing the opening two words with a shared preparation.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

WARM-UP 02

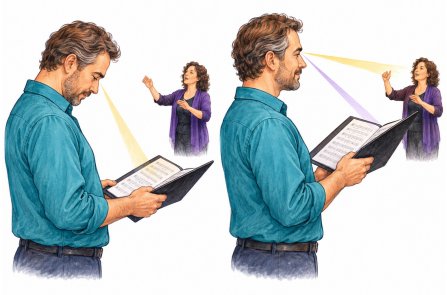
Late Start, Clear Cue

Express Warm-Ups

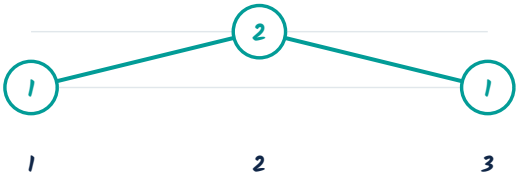
5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Recover focus when rehearsal begins late.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Find the first score page and look up.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Follow two silent preparation gestures with normal breathing.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-2-1 only after the response cue.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Practise the first entrance once, then start the planned task.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

Seated Start

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a seated ensemble.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Support feet and raise the score comfortably.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Speak one line with an easy jaw.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Sing two short 'mm-oo' patterns with rests.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Look up before a shared two-beat sung response.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

Words Before Notes

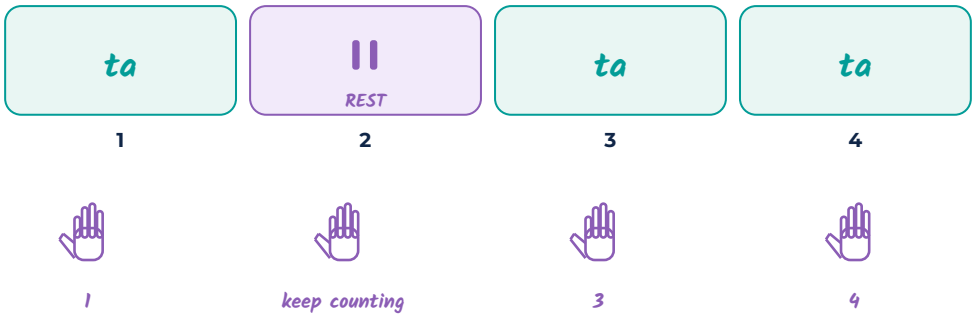
Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Clarify a text-heavy opening.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS



Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Speak the lyric naturally.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Mark one sensible breath before the first phrase.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Speak the words in rhythm, then sing their vowels.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Restore concise consonants and sing the complete line.

WATCH FOR THIS

The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

WARM-UP 05

Pulse in a Hurry

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Establish one dependable tempo.

MODEL / LISTEN

ta ta ti-ti ta

RESPONSE / ECHO

ta ta ti-ti ta

wait for cue

Hear the complete four-beat model before the response cue.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Tap four slow even beats.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Speak 'ta ta ti-ti ta' while the beat continues.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Echo two short rhythms with a full listening gap.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Sing one rhythmically simple phrase without accelerating.

WATCH FOR THIS

The response starts after the complete model and preserves its long and short sounds.

Quiet Room Entry

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Start gently in a resonant space.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Check that neighbours and director are audible.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Use an ordinary breath before a short spoken line.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Hum briefly, then sing 3-2-1 at gentle volume.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Sing one phrase while keeping the text clear without added loudness.

WATCH FOR THIS

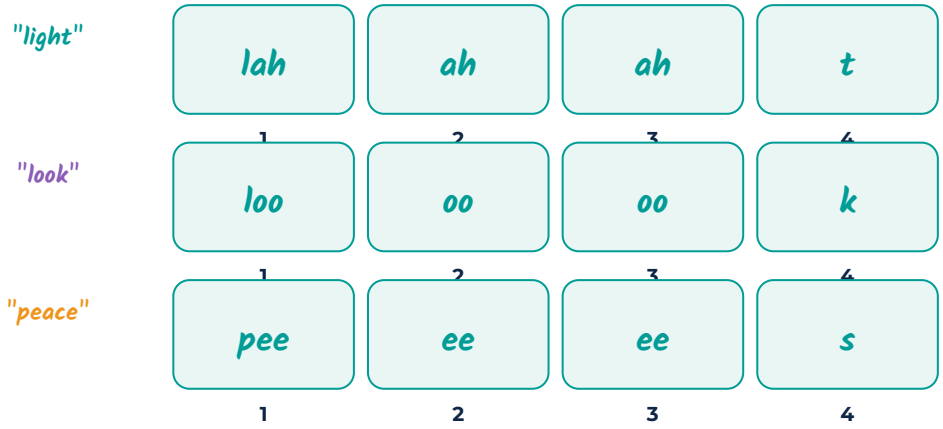
The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

Clean Last Word

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare an ending before a short run.



Hold the vowel through beat 3; agree one final-consonant event on beat 4.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Locate the last word and release mark.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Speak its vowel and final consonant separately.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Sing the word for three beats and release together on four.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Reconnect the final two words and watch the cut-off.

WATCH FOR THIS

There is one clear consonant event rather than several scattered endings.

WARM-UP 08

Easy Pitch Match

Express Warm-Ups

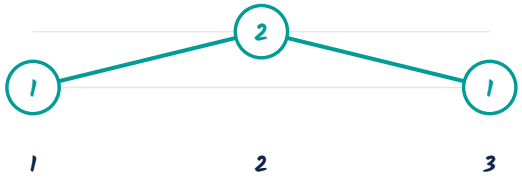
5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Settle the starting note.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Listen silently to a comfortable reference.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Hum the note for two beats and rest.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-2-1, then hear the reference again.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Sing the song's first note and its opening phrase.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

Page-Turn Rescue

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prevent a rushed entrance after a page turn.

	1	2	3	4
"light"	lah	ah	ah	t
"look"	loo	oo	oo	k
"peace"	pee	ee	ee	s

Hold the vowel through beat 3; agree one final-consonant event on beat 4.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Practise the page turn silently.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Look up and allow an ordinary breath.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Sing one gentle 'loo' after the preparatory gesture.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Join the final word before the turn to the first word afterwards.

WATCH FOR THIS

There is one clear consonant event rather than several scattered endings.

WARM-UP 10

Jaw Release Reminder

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Reduce visibly clenched articulation.



oo — oh — ah

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Let teeth remain unclenched and lips part naturally.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Say 'yeah, yeah' conversationally.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Sing 'oo-oh' on one note with rests.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Speak then sing a short lyric without exaggerating the mouth movement.

WATCH FOR THIS

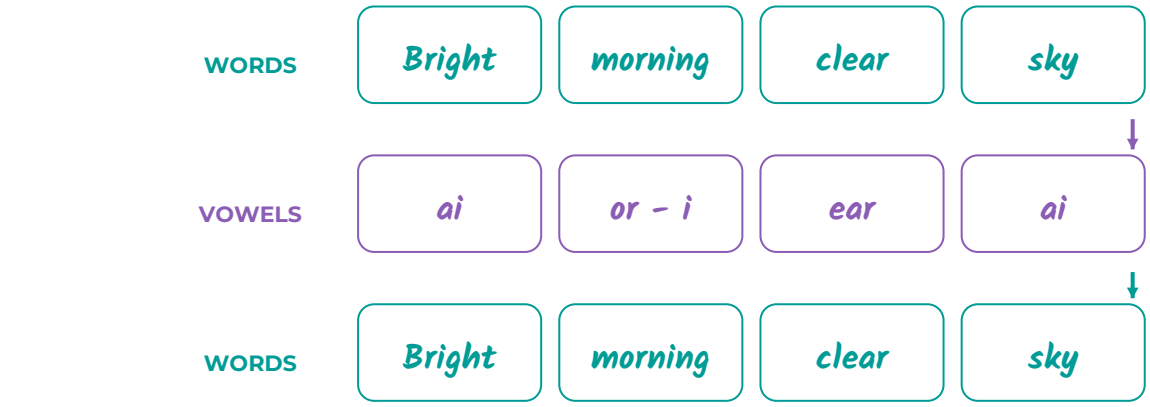
Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

One Shared Vowel

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a word with inconsistent pronunciation.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Speak the target word without singing.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Choose a shared version suitable to its language.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Sing that vowel on a comfortable note.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Place the complete word back into its phrase.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

After Announcements

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Return attention to music after a long discussion.



Watch the preparation | Breathe without holding | "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Show the ready, repeat, and stop signals.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Follow a silent ready cue with normal breathing.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Echo one short three-note pattern.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Sing a chosen two-bar entry with everyone watching first.

WATCH FOR THIS

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.

Soft Re-entry

Express Warm-Ups

5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare after a quiet instrumental gap.



mm oo oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

Locate the next word and cue.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Think the entry rhythm while tapping gently.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Hum the reference, rest, then sing it again.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Rehearse only the gap and re-entry at comfortable volume.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

Welcoming a New Singer

Express Warm-Ups

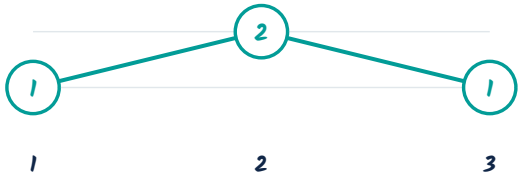
5 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Help a newcomer enter without a solo test.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 01:00

Settle & focus

A buddy locates the page and starting words.

01:00 to 02:00

Prepare

Speak the line together in the full group.

02:00 to 04:00

Coordinate

Echo 1-2-1 with an option to listen.

04:00 to 05:00

Apply it now

Sing the opening phrase and answer one practical question.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

WARM-UP 15

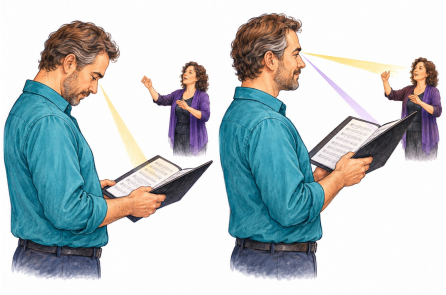
Connected Five-Note Line

Express Warm-Ups

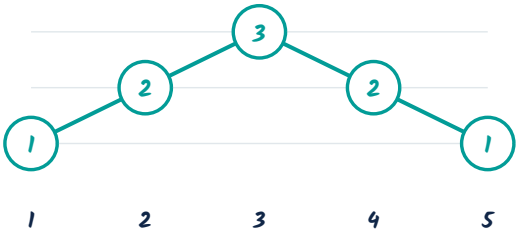
10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Join notes without jaw pulses.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Find an easy stance and release the score grip.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak a short phrase after a natural breath.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing 1-2-3-2-1 on separate 'loo', then one connected 'oo', resting between turns.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Apply the connected sound to the actual vowels and then the words of a five-note phrase.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

Rhythm and Rest

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Make a rest active rather than uncertain.

MODEL / LISTEN	RESPONSE / ECHO
ta ta ti-ti ta	ta ta ti-ti ta

wait for cue

Hear the complete four-beat model before the response cue.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Tap a steady pulse while speaking the count.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak a short lyric with its punctuation.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Alternate 'ta rest ta ta' and 'ta ta ti-ti ta' slowly.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Sing a real passage containing the rest, then recheck the following entry.

WATCH FOR THIS

The response starts after the complete model and preserves its long and short sounds.

Descending Clarity

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep low phrase endings from becoming pressed.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Release shoulder lifting and chin bracing.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Take ordinary breaths between short spoken lines.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Use gentle 3-2-1 patterns, extending to five notes only if comfortable.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Rehearse an actual descending ending and compare its final note to a reference.

WATCH FOR THIS

The final notes stay clear without being pushed downward.

Blend Without Disappearing

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Balance a unison phrase while preserving clear words.



oo — oh — ah

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

The mouth shape changes while pitch and volume stay reasonably steady.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Arrange clear sightlines between rows.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak the main text naturally and mark a breath.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing 'oo-oh-ah' on one shared comfortable note without changing volume.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Sing a unison phrase, listen across the row, and adjust only excessive individual volume.

WATCH FOR THIS

Vowel changes are audible while pitch and volume stay reasonably consistent.

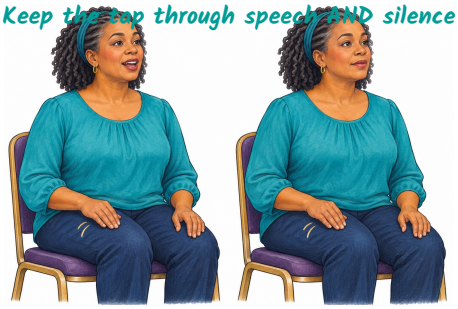
Upbeat Confidence

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Link preparation to a reliable first vowel.

Keep the tap through speech AND silence



tap	tap	tap	tap
1	2	3	4

The pulse continues through four silent beats, then the line returns in time.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Review the silent ready signal.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Follow the preparation with an ordinary breath and no hold.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing one 'loo' on the next downbeat; vary the wait before preparation.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Use the same gesture at three different song entrances.

WATCH FOR THIS

The beat continues steadily during silence.

Consonant Timing Clinic

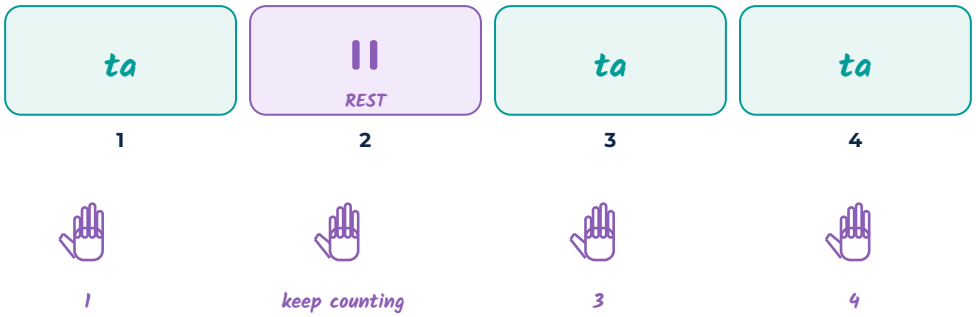
Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Align starts and endings in one short text.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS



Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Speak the line and find initial and final consonants.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Mark its natural breathing point.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing the line on one note, placing vowels on beats and final consonants at the release.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Restore the melody and compare two takes for word clarity.

WATCH FOR THIS

The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

Two-Part Readiness

Express Warm-Ups

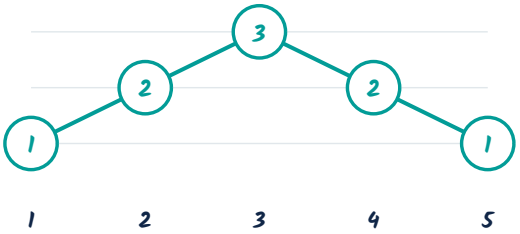
10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a simple overlap with clear balance.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Place two groups so they can hear each other.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Rehearse an easy breath and short home note.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

One group sings home while the other echoes 1-2-3-2-1; exchange with rests.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Rehearse two overlapping entries, reducing the new part if it hides the continuing text.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

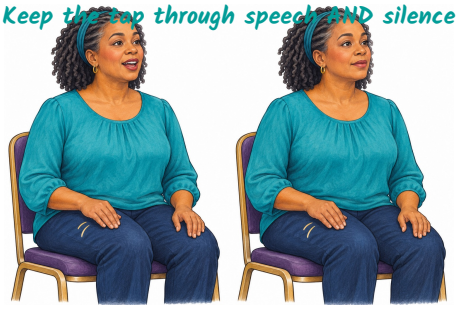
Memory Refresh

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Recover a phrase without repeated score staring.

Keep the tap through speech AND silence



tap	tap	tap	tap
1	2	3	4

The pulse continues through four silent beats, then the line returns in time.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Read the first two bars together.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak its words and identify one breath.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing a short pattern, think it for two silent beats, then repeat it.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Sing the phrase from a landmark word, checking the score only after each attempt.

WATCH FOR THIS

The beat continues steadily during silence.

Meaning in the Vowels

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Connect a technical start to expressive text.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Speak the lyric and choose its central word.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Plan a comfortable breath before the line.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Hum to 'oo', then sing the phrase on its actual vowels.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Restore consonants and direct the line toward the chosen word without shouting it.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

Meter Switch

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Distinguish groups of two and three.



Feet supported | Use a stable chair | See the director without craning

Comfort and a clear sightline matter more than a rigid pose.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Use seated down-up and down-side-up gestures.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak 'ONE two' and 'ONE two three' with normal breaths.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing short three-note phrases while keeping each grouping clear.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Apply the correct gesture to the next piece and verify the first entrance.

WATCH FOR THIS

Eyes can reach the director without craning the neck.

Listening Before Singing

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Reduce guesses in an unfamiliar melody.



Front and side views of a supported singing stance.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Agree that a raised hand means listen.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak one preparation phrase quietly.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Hear pairs of higher, lower, and same notes, identify the direction, then echo.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Listen to a two-bar melody, trace its contour, and sing it only after a complete model.

WATCH FOR THIS

Feet remain quiet and the first sung phrase feels as easy as speaking.

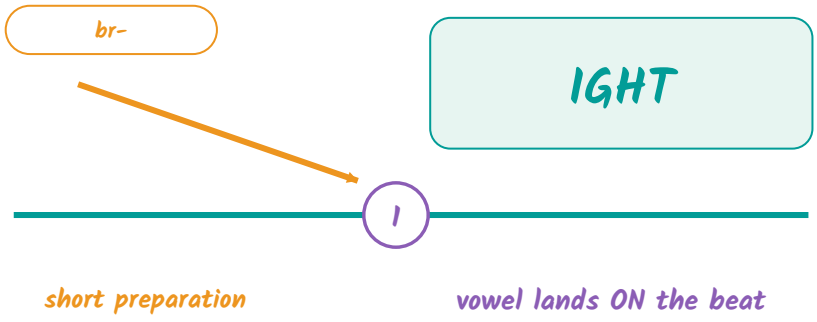
WARM-UP 26

Final Phrase Focus

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a secure ending with clear punctuation.



The consonant prepares the word; the vowel meets the shared beat.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Mark the final breath and destination word.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak the last line as a sentence.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Sing the final note, then rebuild from the last word backwards in short units.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Perform the full ending with its planned consonant, release, and two beats of attention.

WATCH FOR THIS

The first vowel arrives together while the word remains recognizable.

Low-Energy Reconnect

Express Warm-Ups

10 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Regain engagement without demanding more volume.



Feet supported | Use a stable chair | See the director without craning

Comfort and a clear sightline matter more than a rigid pose.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Choose seated or standing participation and release hand grip.

02:00 to 04:00

Prepare

Speak a greeting to a partner at conversational level.

04:00 to 07:00

Coordinate

Echo two gentle patterns with clear listening turns and rests.

07:00 to 10:00

Apply it now

Sing one familiar phrase with a concrete meaning and identify one improvement.

WATCH FOR THIS

Eyes can reach the director without craning the neck.

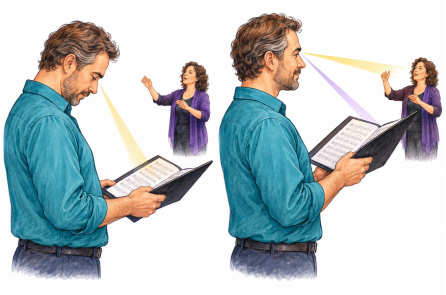
Full Rehearsal Launch

Express Warm-Ups

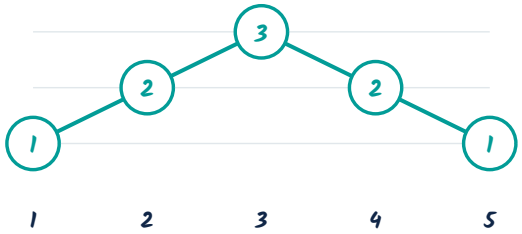
15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare body, sound, and a specific repertoire challenge.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Settle posture, sightlines, and score handling.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Map a breath in the day's opening phrase.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use 'mm-oo', 1-2-3-2-1, and one rhythm echo with generous rests.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Rehearse the selected challenge first on one vowel, then with complete text, checking one criterion.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

Performance-Day Economy

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare without spending the voice before an event.



mm — oo — oh

ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Check comfort, access routes, and score readiness.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak the opening text and rehearse one silent preparation.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use brief gentle hums and two familiar middle-range patterns, with rest between turns.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Practise one opening and one ending, then stop and allow quiet recovery rather than running everything.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

New Repertoire Gateway

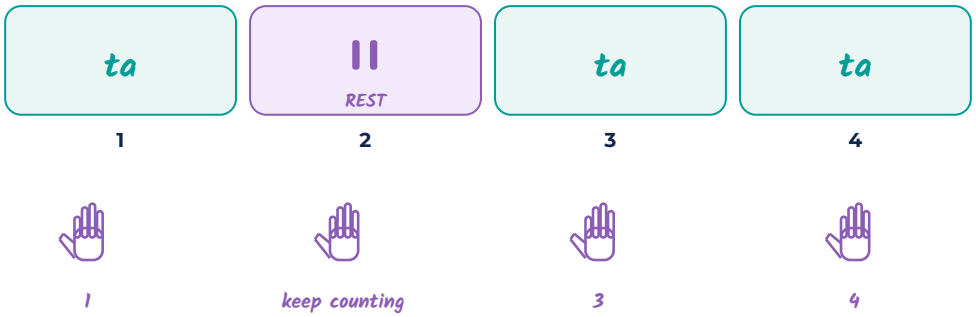
Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Separate a new song's rhythm, contour, and words.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS



Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Find the score's first entrance and page layout.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Read the text naturally and choose a phrase breath.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Echo a short melodic cell after identifying its direction; rest before repeating.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Speak the rhythm, sing the notes on 'oo', then combine the first complete phrase.

WATCH FOR THIS

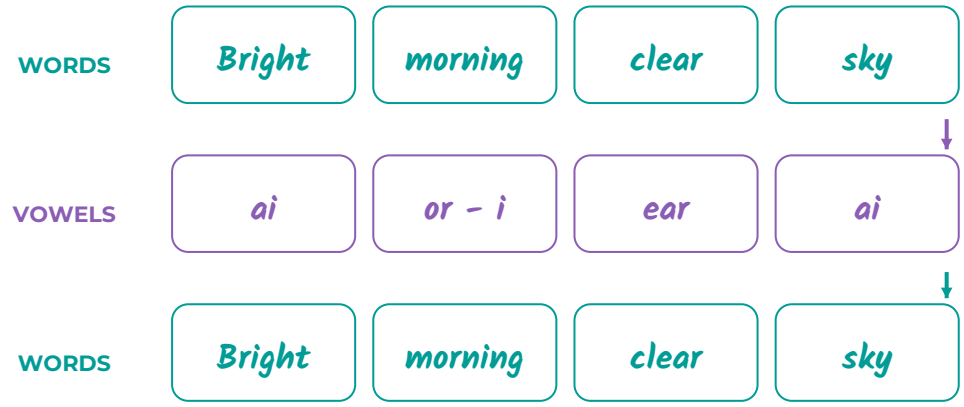
The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

Church Choir Preparation

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare a reflective or celebratory service item with clear text.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Check where the choir will sit or stand and how it will see the director.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak the selected text respectfully and locate natural punctuation.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use gentle descending patterns and one shared-vowel exercise with recovery pauses.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Rehearse the opening cue, an important text line, and the final release for the actual service order.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

Children's Group Launch

Express Warm-Ups

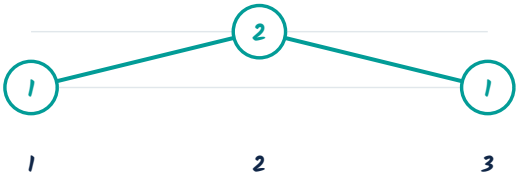
15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare attention and sound through short, clear turns.

PREPARE WITH EASE



THE PRINTED PATTERN



Scale degrees, not fixed pitches. Use the syllables and recovery pauses in the timed steps.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Use a name echo with an option to speak or pass.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Practise a quiet preparation gesture and an ordinary breath.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Alternate short 1-2-1 echoes with 'ta rest ta ta', keeping every turn brief.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Speak and sing one familiar line, then let the group name the ready and stop signals.

WATCH FOR THIS

The middle note does not trigger a sudden shout or chin lift.

Youth Choir Launch

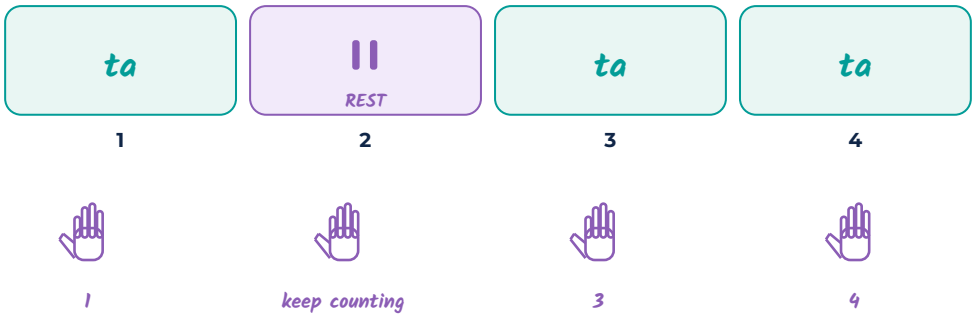
Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Offer flexible participation while coordinating entrances.

Then rest before another attempt

FOUR EVEN BEATS



Beat 2 is an action: open the hands silently and keep counting.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Check comfortable octaves and allow listening when range is uncertain.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak a lyric with a clear meaning and natural breath.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Choose a three-note or four-note echo, then practise a rhythm with one active rest.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Combine text and melody in a short passage, using a planned re-entry after silence.

WATCH FOR THIS

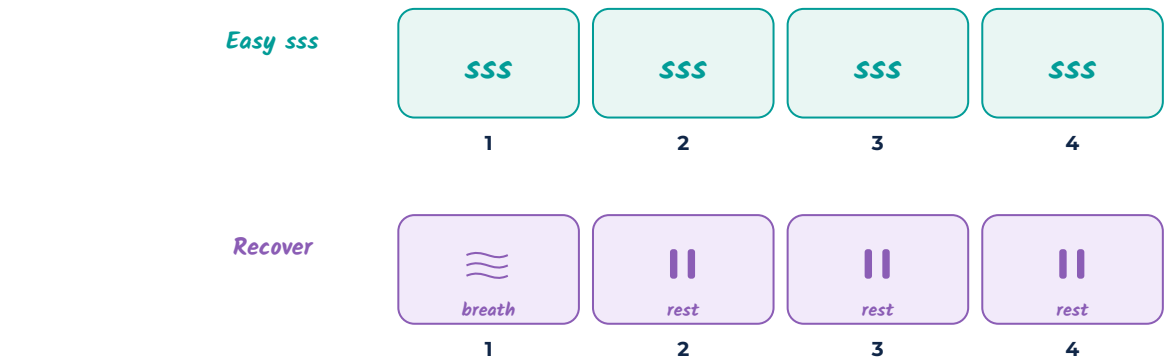
The note after the rest arrives on time without an extra cue.

Community Choir Blend

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Connect a mixed-experience group through listening.



One even four-beat release, then normal breathing before another attempt.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Recheck spacing and invite one practical rehearsal preference.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak the main line and agree where to breathe.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use a shared home note, a vowel change, and a short descending pattern with rests.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Rotate listeners and singers on one phrase, then apply one descriptive ensemble observation.

WATCH FOR THIS

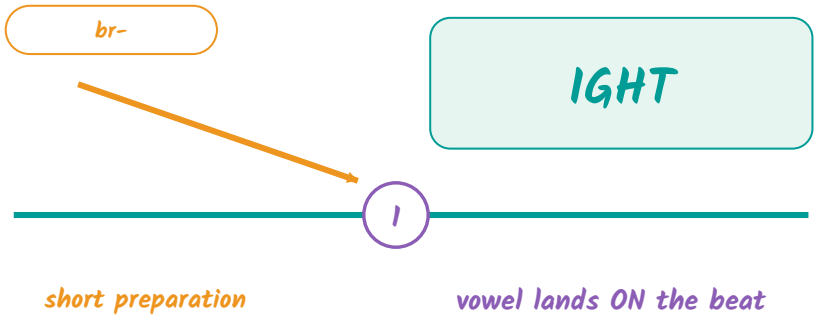
The air stream stays even and the ending does not collapse or squeeze.

Articulation and Pulse

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Keep clear words inside a reliable rhythm.



The consonant prepares the word; the vowel meets the shared beat.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Release jaw and finger tension without exaggerated stretching.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak the target line slowly after an easy breath.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Practise syllable train, final-consonant timing, and a short gentle repeated-note pattern.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Sing the real text at a manageable tempo, keeping its consonants concise as speed increases slightly.

WATCH FOR THIS

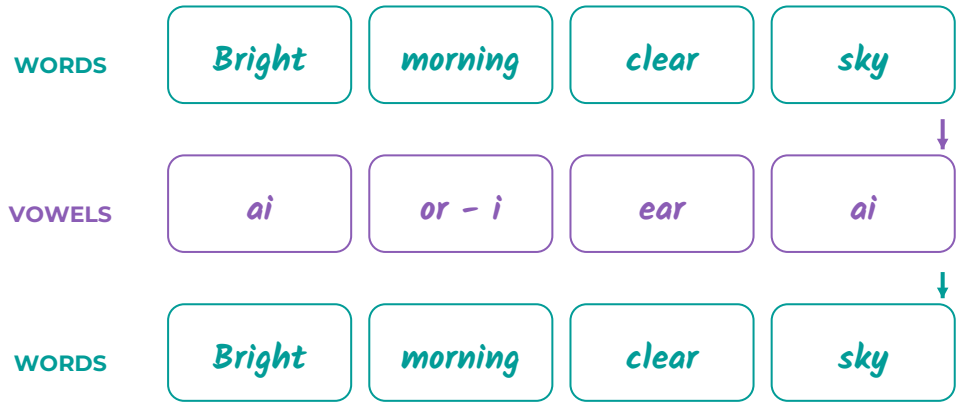
The first vowel arrives together while the word remains recognizable.

Expressive Phrase Builder

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Move from sound preparation to an intentional phrase.



A simplified teaching example: restore the words without losing the vowel line.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Read the lyric and choose an intention suited to its meaning.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Plan a breath that leaves the sentence intact.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use a continuous-vowel pattern and two comfortable dynamic levels, resting between turns.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Sing the target phrase with one destination word, then ask listeners what message they heard.

WATCH FOR THIS

The restored text remains as connected as the vowel-only version.

Transition Specialist

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Make an awkward handover between sections dependable.



Watch the preparation | Breathe without holding | "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Identify the finishing word in A and the entrance in B.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak both lines with their natural breathing places.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Establish each group's starting pitch and echo the handover rhythm separately.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Join both parts slowly, then in context, adjusting volume so the finishing text remains audible.

WATCH FOR THIS

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.

Confident Internal Restart

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Prepare recovery from a mistake or missed entrance.



- Watch the preparation
- Breathe without holding
- "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Mark two internal landmarks with page and bar numbers.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak each landmark's first words after a natural preparation.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Hear the starting notes, think them silently, and sing them after a clear cue.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Practise a planned stop and rejoin at each landmark without returning to the song's beginning.

WATCH FOR THIS

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.

Room and Microphone Readiness

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Adapt to the space while maintaining normal vocal effort.



ONE COMFORTABLE NOTE

Keep one comfortable pitch and a similar volume as the vowel opens.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Check sightlines, cables, and safe standing or seated positions.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak the opening text at a normal level and plan its breath.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use a few short comfortable hum-to-vowel and descending patterns with rest.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Sing a representative passage for a listener or sound operator; adjust placement and clarity before volume.

WATCH FOR THIS

The vowel opens without becoming louder or more effortful.

Final Integration Circuit

Express Warm-Ups

15 minutes total / Timings include modelling, listening and recovery

Check readiness across timing, sound, text, and meaning.



Watch the preparation | Breathe without holding | "loo" on the downbeat

Respond to the gesture; do not guess how long the pause will last.

00:00 to 02:00

Settle & focus

Choose one target and ensure everyone can see the cue.

02:00 to 05:00

Prepare

Speak the target phrase, marking one unforced breath.

05:00 to 10:00

Coordinate

Use its pitch cell on 'oo', its rhythm in speech, and one gentle shared-vowel task.

10:00 to 15:00

Apply it now

Sing the full phrase twice with a reset between attempts, then record the next specific rehearsal action.

WATCH FOR THIS

Entrances occur together after the preparation, without a premature gasp.